

UPSC CIVIL SERVICES EXAMINATION 2026

PRELIMS GENERAL STUDIES - PAPER 1

Official Question Paper with Detailed Explanations & Model Solutions

Total Questions: 100 | Max Marks: 200 | Time Allowed: 2 Hours

QUESTION 1

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Indian Geography** | Topic: **Drainage System, Rivers, River Interlinking**

Consider the following assertion:

In the Pleistocene period either the Yamuna once flowed into the Indus, or the Sutlej flowed into the Yamuna and one major tributary of either had shifted from the Ganga to the Indus or vice versa.

Which of the following is/are the basis of the above assertion?

1. The Nadi-Sukta of the Rigveda
2. The explorations of the Sutlej and the Yamuna by Robert Bruce Foote
3. The presence of the same species of dolphins in both the Indus and the Ganga river systems

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 2	(d) 3

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

The present drainage pattern of northern India has evolved over a long geological timescale due to processes such as **tectonic movements, river capture, sediment deposition, and climatic changes**. Geographers and geologists reconstruct these ancient river courses using evidence from **geomorphology, palaeontology, archaeology, and biogeography**.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Nadi-Sukta in the **Rigveda** mentions several rivers of north-western India, including the **Saraswati**. It is often used in historical and cultural discussions regarding ancient river systems. However, it does **not provide geological or geomorphological evidence** about river capture or drainage shifts between the **Indus** and **Ganga** systems during the Pleistocene period.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Robert Bruce Foote is widely regarded as the "**Father of Indian Prehistory**" because of his pioneering geological and archaeological work, especially in **South India**. His major contributions were associated with regions such as present-day **Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh**, and parts of western India. He is particularly known for discovering Paleolithic tools at **Pallavaram near Chennai**.

However, the assertion given in the question relates to the **palaeo-channel shifts of the Yamuna, Sutlej, Indus, and Ganga systems** during the Pleistocene period. This conclusion is derived mainly from **geomorphological, tectonic, sedimentary, and faunal evidence**, not from Foote's explorations.

Statement 3 is correct: Freshwater dolphins normally remain confined to river systems and cannot migrate across seas like marine dolphins. Therefore, the presence of the same or closely related dolphin species in both the **Indus** and **Ganga** river systems suggests that these rivers were once connected. However, these 2 species are recently been considered as separate species and not the same.

South Asian river dolphin populations are now geographically separated, but their distribution is treated as important **biogeographical evidence** of an earlier hydrological link between the two drainage systems. This supports the theory that major rivers such as the **Yamuna** or **Sutlej** changed their courses due to **river capture** or tectonic shifts during the Pleistocene period.

QUESTION 2

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Sculpture**

What does an empty seat represent in early Buddhist iconography?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| (a) The meditation of the Buddha | (b) The Buddha's First Sermon |
| (c) The Buddha's Mahaparinibbana | (d) The Buddha's Mahabhinishkramana |

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Early Buddhist art initially followed the **aniconic tradition**, where the Buddha was not depicted in human form. Instead, artists used various symbols to represent important events associated with the life and teachings of the Buddha.

In early Buddhist iconography, the **empty seat** symbolised the presence of the Buddha during his meditation and enlightenment. Rather than depicting the Buddha physically, sculptors represented him indirectly through symbolic motifs.

The empty throne or seat particularly signified the Buddha meditating under the **Bodhi tree** at **Bodh Gaya**, where he attained enlightenment.

QUESTION 3

Subject: History | Section: Ancient | Topic: Vedic Age

Which of the following pairs of ancient and modern names of rivers is/are correctly matched?

1. Vitasta: Chenab
2. Asikni: Jhelum
3. Parushni: Ravi
4. Yavyavati: Beas

Select the answer using the code given below:

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 | (b) 3 and 4 |
| (c) 3 Only | (d) 4 Only |

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The early Vedic region, especially the area described in the **Rigvedic river hymns**, largely covered the north-western part of the Indian subcontinent up to the **Yamuna**.

Pair 1 is incorrect: In Vedic literature, **Vitasta** refers to the modern **Jhelum River**, not the Chenab.

Pair 2 is incorrect: The word **Asikni** literally means "dark-coloured," and it is identified with the **Chenab** river and not Jhelum.

Pair 3 is correct: The river **Parushni** mentioned in the Rigveda is identified with the modern **Ravi River**.

Pair 4 is incorrect: The modern **Beas River** was known in ancient texts as **Vipash (Vipasha)**, not Yavyavati.

QUESTION 4

Subject: History | Section: Art & Culture | Topic: Sculpture

Which of the following statements on the Amaravati Stupa and its relief sculpture is/are correct?

1. It was located in the lower Krishna valley.
2. In India, it was next only to the Sanchi Stupa in size.
3. The Amaravati school of sculpture made a lasting impact on the later South Indian sculpture, and its products were carried to Sri Lanka and South-east Asia.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The Amaravati Stupa represents one of the finest achievements of early Buddhist art in peninsular India. Flourishing mainly under the **Satavahanas** and later the **Ikshvakus**, the Amaravati tradition became known for its refined limestone reliefs, dynamic narrative panels, and strong maritime cultural links.

Statement 1 is correct: The Amaravati Stupa was situated in the **lower Krishna valley** in present-day Andhra Pradesh. The Krishna region emerged as an important centre of Buddhist activity due to prosperous trade routes and urban growth during the Satavahana period.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Amaravati Stupa was indeed one of the largest Buddhist stupas in ancient India. In reality, the Amaravati Stupa was **taller than the Great Stupa at Sanchi**.

Statement 3 is correct: The Amaravati school became famous for its highly sophisticated sculptural style marked by **narrative depth, ornamental richness, and fluid human figures**. Its influence can be seen in later South Indian artistic traditions. Archaeological and artistic evidence also indicates strong cultural connections between the Krishna valley and regions such as **Sri Lanka** and parts of **South-East Asia** through maritime trade and Buddhist missionary activity.

QUESTION 5

Subject: History | Section: Ancient | Topic: Sangam Age

Which of the following pairs of the king and his dynasty in early historical Tamilakam is/are not correctly matched?

1. Senguttuvan: Chera
2. Udiyanjeral: Chola
3. Nedunjeliyan: Pandya

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The history of early historical Tamilakam is reconstructed mainly from **Sangam literature**, inscriptions and archaeological evidence. The three major dynasties of this period were the **Chera**, **Chola**, and **Pandya** kingdoms. Their rulers frequently appear in Sangam poems in connection with warfare, trade, patronage of poets, and overseas contacts, particularly with the Romans.

Pair 1 is correct: Senguttuvan was one of the most celebrated rulers of the **Chera dynasty**. He was also known as the Red or Good Chera. He is remembered in the post-Sangam epic *Silappadikaram* as a powerful king who undertook military expeditions and patronised the cult of **Kannagi**, regarded as the goddess of chastity. Sangam traditions also describe him as having marched northwards, crossed the **Ganga**, and brought stone for constructing an image of Kannagi.

Pair 2 is incorrect: Udiyanjeral was an early ruler of the **Chera dynasty**, not the Chola dynasty. He is considered one of the earliest known Chera kings and is associated with the rise of Chera political power in western Tamilakam.

Pair 3 is correct: Nedunjeliyan was a ruler of the **Pandya dynasty**. Several Pandya kings bearing this title are mentioned in Sangam texts. The Pandyas ruled mainly over the southern part of Tamilakam with centres around **Madurai**, which emerged as an important political and cultural centre during the Sangam age.

QUESTION 6

Subject: **History** | Section: **Modern** | Topic: **Gandhian Phase (Post-1917 till Partition, including NCM, CDM, QIM, Simon Commission, etc.)**

Which of the following factors contributed to the formation of the Forward Bloc by Subhas Chandra Bose in 1939?

1. Bose failed to win the confidence of Mahatma Gandhi.
2. The Congress Left was disunited and failed to support Bose.
3. The Communists did not support Bose in his endeavours.
4. The supporters of M.N. Roy and socialist leaders like Jayaprakash Narayan preferred Congress unity to supporting Bose.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4	(d) 2 and 4 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The formation of the All India Forward Bloc was closely linked to the ideological tensions within the Congress after the **Tripuri Session of 1939**. The conflict reflected differing views on the timing and method of the anti-colonial struggle, especially between Bose's radical approach and Gandhi's cautious strategy.

Statement 1 is correct: Although Bose won the Congress presidential election at Tripuri, he could not secure Mahatma Gandhi's confidence. Bose favoured an immediate mass struggle and even proposed giving the British government an ultimatum for independence.

Gandhiji, however, believed that the country and the Congress organisation were not yet prepared for such a confrontation. The ideological gap between the two leaders widened further when Bose failed to form a working committee acceptable to the Gandhian camp.

Statement 2 is correct: The Left within the Congress lacked unity and organisational cohesion. Though several socialist and radical groups were sympathetic to Bose's militant line, they were unwilling to risk a split in the Congress. As a result, Bose did not receive consistent support from the broader Left bloc during the Tripuri crisis.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The issue was not outright Communist opposition to Bose. The source material indicates that the Communists, like many other Left groups, were mainly concerned about preserving Congress unity during the national movement. They feared that a split in the Congress would weaken the anti-colonial struggle and reduce the influence of the Left.

Statement 4 is correct: Many Royists and socialist leaders believed that maintaining a united Congress under Gandhi's leadership was more important than backing Bose in an organisational confrontation. Since the Congress was the principal vehicle of the freedom struggle, these groups avoided supporting any move that could divide the organisation. This weakened Bose politically and eventually led to his resignation and the formation of the **Forward Bloc in May 1939**.

QUESTION 7

Subject: **History** | Section: **Modern** | Topic: **Governor Generals and Their Policies, Administrative Developments, Judicial Developments, Civil Services, Police, Military**

Consider the following statements regarding the British policy in Awadh immediately after its annexation in 1856:

1. The taluqdars were dispossessed of their estates but allowed to retain their arms and forts.
2. A Summary Revenue Settlement was made in 1856 assuming that the taluqdars were outsiders.
3. The British believed in taking revenue directly from the peasants by removing the taluqdars.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 2 and 3 only	(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3	(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

The **annexation of Awadh by the British in 1856** brought **major administrative and agrarian** changes. The British attempted to **restructure land revenue administration** by **weakening the power of the taluqdars**, who had traditionally exercised control over large estates and local authority. These measures created widespread resentment and became one of the important causes behind the Revolt of 1857 in Awadh.

Statement 1 is incorrect: After annexing Awadh, the British not only removed many taluqdars from their estates but also took steps to weaken their political and military influence. Their forts were dismantled and their armed retainers were disbanded in many cases. **The British viewed the taluqdars as centres of local resistance and therefore did not allow them to freely retain military power.**

Statement 2 is correct: Following the annexation, the British introduced the **Summary Revenue Settlement of 1856** in Awadh. British officials argued that taluqdars were merely intermediaries or outsiders who had usurped the rights of the actual cultivators. On this basis, many taluqdars were deprived of their estates and revenue rights.

Statement 3 is correct: The **British administration attempted to establish direct relations with village-level cultivators and collect revenue without the involvement of taluqdars.** This policy was based on the assumption that removing intermediaries would improve revenue administration and increase state control. However, it alienated the taluqdars, who later played a major role in supporting the Revolt of 1857 in Awadh.

QUESTION 8

Subject: **History** | Section: **Modern** | Topic: **Constitutional Developments**

Consider the following assertion:

The genesis of political alliances based on community lay in the very nature of the Montague-Chelmsford Reforms, 1919.

Which of the following statements support/supports the above assertion?

1. Reforms retained and extended the principle of separate electorates.
2. Separate electorates were supposed to counter Indian nationalism, which was growing stronger.
3. Deprived classes rallied around the favours inherent in separate electorates.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

The **Government of India Act 1919** introduced limited constitutional reforms in British India but also **deepened communal representation in politics**. By expanding the system of separate electorates and encouraging representation on religious and social lines, the reforms strengthened community-based political mobilisation.

Statement 1 is correct: The Montagu–Chelmsford Reforms continued the system of **separate electorates** that had first been introduced for Muslims under the **Indian Councils Act 1909**. The 1919 reforms further extended communal representation to additional groups such as **Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians, and Europeans** in certain provinces. This **institutionalised politics along community lines**.

Statement 2 is correct: The British policy of separate electorates formed part of the broader strategy of **"divide and rule."** By encouraging political representation based on religion and community, the colonial administration sought to weaken the emergence of a united nationalist movement. The British believed that dividing political interests along communal lines would reduce the possibility of a consolidated anti-colonial struggle led by the Congress.

Statement 3 is correct: Over time, several socially and politically marginalised groups began viewing separate electorates and reserved political representation as instruments for securing political safeguards and access to power. **Different communities increasingly organised themselves politically to demand constitutional concessions and representation within the colonial framework.** Thus, communal and group-based political alliances gained further momentum.

QUESTION 9

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Performing Arts (Dance, Drama, Music, Martial Arts)**

Pandit Mallikarjun Mansur, the famous classical singer from Karnataka, represented the:

(a) Agra Gharana	(b) Gwalior Gharana
(c) Patiala Gharana	(d) Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Mallikarjun Mansur was one of the most distinguished exponents of **Hindustani classical music** in the twentieth century. Born in **Dharwad region of Karnataka**, he became especially renowned for his mastery over rare ragas and complex khayal compositions. His music reflected the distinctive stylistic depth of the **Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana**, a tradition known for its intricate raga architecture and intellectual rigour.

He trained under Manji Khan and Bhurji Khan, sons of Ustad Alladiya Khan, the founder of this gharana. He became widely respected for preserving and popularising several rare and complex ragas of the Jaipur-Atrauli tradition. His contribution earned him honours such as the **Padma Vibhushan** and the **Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship**.

QUESTION 10

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Vedic Age**

In which one among the following texts does the term kshetra-patni ('mistress of the field') originate?

(a) Rigveda	(b) Atharvaveda
(c) Ashtadhyayi	(d) Arthashastra

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The Rigveda contains several references to early agricultural practices, fertility, cultivation, and prayers associated with productive land. Although early Vedic society retained strong pastoral features, agriculture had already acquired growing importance. Deities connected with cultivated fields and agricultural prosperity appear in Rigvedic hymns. The term **Kshetrapati** ("lord/protector of the field") is explicitly mentioned in the Rigveda in connection with agricultural land and fertility. The text contains hymns invoking agricultural prosperity, rains, crops, and protection of fields.

The feminine expression kshetra-patni ("mistress of the field") is associated with the Atharva Veda.

QUESTION 11

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Performing Arts (Dance, Drama, Music, Martial Arts)**

Which one of the following Carnatic music ragas is similar to Raga Bilawal in Hindustani music?

(a) Nat Bhairavi	(b) Kamavardhini
(c) Hanumatodi	(d) Dheera Shankarabharanam

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Indian national anthem **Jana Gana Mana** is based on the **Carnatic raga Dheera Shankarabharanam**, which corresponds to **Raga Bilawal in Hindustani music**. Shankarabharanam means 'the ornament of Shiva' and is considered a healing raga in music therapy. It is cherished as a favourite of Lord Shiva who is the Vaidishwar or god of doctors, and is said to produce a feeling of empowerment and well-being in listeners.

QUESTION 12

Subject: **History** | Section: **Modern** | Topic: **Governor Generals and Their Policies, Administrative Developments, Judicial Developments, Civil Services, Police, Military**

The artificially fixed rupee-sterling exchange rate prescribed by the Hilton-Young Commission (1926) was adopted by the British Government for which one of the following reasons?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (a) Aiding the flow of remittances from India and maintaining India's creditworthiness | (b) Providing support to Indian importers |
| (c) Encouraging export of cotton produce from India | (d) Preventing depreciation of the Rupee in terms of gold |

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

The artificially fixed **rupee-sterling exchange rate at 1s 6d** was prescribed by the Hilton-Young Commission and adopted by the British government "to aid the flow of remittances from India and to maintain India's credit-worthiness." Under colonial rule, Britain regularly transferred large amounts of money from India in the form of administrative expenses, pensions, debt payments, and profits. A stable exchange rate ensured smooth remittances to Britain and protected India's reputation in international financial markets.

QUESTION 13

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Mahajanapadas**

Consider the following statements:

1. Pali texts contain the first definite references to coins, e.g., kahapana, nikkha, kamsa, and kakanika.
2. The literary evidence from Pali texts is corroborated by archaeological evidence of punch-marked coins from many sites, most of them made of silver.

The above statements have been associated with which of the following?

1. Emergence of urban life
2. Transition to money economy

Select the answer using the code given below:

- | | |
|------------------|---------------------|
| (a) 1 only | (b) 2 only |
| (c) Both 1 and 2 | (d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. Pali texts referred to several types of **coins**, which **indicates the existence of active trade and commercial exchange**. The archaeological discoveries of punch-marked coins from many sites suggest the use of coins which encouraged trade, markets, specialised occupations, and exchange of goods over long distances. Such expanding commercial activities generally developed in **urban centres**.

Statement 2 is correct. The mention of coins such as **kahapana, nikkha, kamsa, and *kakanika** in Pali texts, along with the archaeological discovery of punch-marked coins, shows increasing use of metallic currency in economic transactions. These developments reflect a shift away from barter exchange towards a money economy.*

QUESTION 14

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Architecture**

Which of the following temples has/have a Nagara-style shikhara?

1. Malegitti Shivalaya, Badami
2. Huchimalligudi Temple, Aihole
3. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh
4. Virupaksha Temple, Pattadakal

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 only	(d) 3 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect. Malegitti Shivalaya of Badami has garbhagriha, pillared Mandapa which is accessed through mukhamandapa. The temple is roofed with **Dravidian shikhara**.

Statement 2 is correct. The Huchimalligudi Temple is an important example of experimentation in temple architecture during the Early Chalukyan age. It signifies the development of the **Rekha-prasada type of shikhara**, which is a characteristic feature of the **Nagara style** prevalent in northern and central India. Thus, this temple represents an early form of Nagara-style shikhara.

Statement 3 is correct. The Dashavatara Temple belongs to the Gupta period and is one of the earliest temples associated with the evolution of the **shikhara**. The presence of curving latina or rekha-prasada type of shikhara also makes it clear that this is an early example of a classic **Nagara style** of temple.

Statement 4 is incorrect. The Virupaksha Temple is predominantly a **Dravidian-style temple**. Although Pattadakal contains examples of both northern and southern architectural traditions, the Virupaksha Temple itself is mainly based on the Dravidian *vimana* style and not on the Nagara style.

QUESTION 15

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Buddhism, Jainism & Other Philosophies**

Among the four main forms of existence of life recognized in Jainism, which one of the following is not included?

(a) Deva (gods)	(b) Yaksha (demi-gods)
(c) Manushya (humans)	(d) Tiryanca (animals and plants)

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Jainism classifies rebirth into **four principal forms of existence (Gati)** based on one's karma. These are **Human beings, Heavenly beings, Tiryanca beings, and Infernal beings**.

Option a is correct. **Deva** or heavenly beings are one of the four recognised forms of existence in Jainism. They enjoy heavenly pleasures due to good karmas but still remain within the cycle of rebirth.

Option b is incorrect. **Yakshas** are semi-divine attendant deities in Jain tradition, but they are **not included among the four principal Gatis**.

Option c is correct. **Human beings are one of the four forms of existence** and are considered most suitable for spiritual progress and attainment of liberation.

Option d is correct. *Tiryancha* includes animals, birds, insects, and plants. These are **recognised as one of the four forms of existence in Jainism.**

QUESTION 16

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Painting**

The Hallisalasya painting in the Bagh Caves represents:

- | | |
|--|---|
| (a) A joyous folk dance | (b) Buddha in a meditative pose |
| (c) The depiction of Shiva and Parvati on Kailasha | (d) Samudramanathan (Churning of the Ocean) |

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

The **Hallisalasya painting** of the Bagh Caves is famous for depicting **joyous folk dance scenes**. The Bagh Caves, located in present-day Madhya Pradesh, belong to the Gupta period and are renowned for their mural paintings.

QUESTION 17

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Post Gupta Period**

Consider the following statements relating to the use of the place-value system in India:

1. The earliest epigraphic use of the place-value system in India is found in the Mankani plates from Gujarat (AD 595-596).
2. In the ninth century, place-values become general in inscriptions all over India.
3. The place-values have been found in Sanskrit inscriptions in South-east Asia as early as the seventh century.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 only | (b) 1 and 3 only |
| (c) 2 and 3 only | (d) 1, 2 and 3 |

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. The earliest epigraphic evidence of the **decimal place-value system** in India is found in the **Mankani copper plates (Sankheda plates)** of Gujarat dated 595–596 CE. It marks an early use of positional numerals in inscriptions.

Statement 2 is correct. By the **ninth century**, the **decimal place-value system had become widely used in inscriptions** across different parts of India. Although some older numeral forms survived locally, the **place-value notation had largely become general by this period.**

Statement 3 is correct. **Sanskrit inscriptions in South-east Asia from the seventh century** show the use of **Indian place-value numerals**. This reflects the spread of Indian mathematical knowledge through cultural contacts.

QUESTION 18

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Indus Valley Civilization**

Consider the following statements about the archaeological findings in Harappan towns:

- I. There is wide occurrence of spindle-whorls in the houses but absence of spinning wheels.
- II. Weights and measurement scales, complete with graduations have been discovered.

III. There are houses built in large part with baked bricks, around relatively spacious courtyards, with their own wells, bathing platforms, and large rooms.

Which of the following inferences can be drawn from the above statements?

1. Statement I suggests that spinning was a laborious activity done at home.
2. Statement II suggests the extent of the scientific knowledge that the Harappans possessed.
3. Statement III suggests the emergence of a common property system.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. The evidence of **spindle whorls, cotton threads, and woven textile** impressions indicates that **spinning and weaving were widely practised** in Harappan society. Since spindle whorls were commonly found, thread-making appears to have been an important **laborious household activity**.

Statement 2 is correct. The discovery of **standardized weights, graduated scales, and precise measurement systems** reflects the **advanced scientific and mathematical knowledge of the Harappans**.

Statement 3 is incorrect. The presence of **large brick houses with courtyards, wells, bathrooms, and separate rooms** indicates **planned urban living and social differentiation**. Some houses were larger and more elaborate than others, suggesting **private ownership and differences in status**. Thus it is not related to the common property system.

QUESTION 19

Subject: **History** | Section: **Modern** | Topic: **Peasant & Working-Class Movements**

Which one of the following statements about the Eka Movement and Bardoli Satyagraha is correct?

(a) The Eka Movement was throughout supported and organized by the Congress while Bardoli Satyagraha was initially independent of Congress influence and was only in the last stages supported by the Congress.	(b) The Eka Movement was provided leadership by the taluqdars of Awadh, whereas the Bardoli Satyagraha was a movement of the landless labourers.
(c) The Bardoli Satyagraha was a campaign against the enhancement of land revenue, while the Eka Movement protest against excessive was a extraction of rents.	(d) The Eka Movement was located in the Varanasi and Mirzapur districts of the present-day U.P., while the Bardoli Satyagraha took place in Saurashtra.

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The Bardoli Satyagraha was launched in Bardoli Taluqa of Surat district after the British government **increased land revenue by 30 per cent**. Under the leadership of Vallabhbhai Patel, peasants refused to pay the revised assessment and demanded an independent inquiry.

Whereas the **Eka Movement emerged** in the districts of Hardoi, Bahraich, and Sitapur in Awadh. The main grievances of peasants were the **extraction of rents much higher than the recorded rates**, oppression by thekedars, and the practice of share-rents. Peasants united under the Eka or "Unity" Movement and pledged to pay only the recorded rent.

QUESTION 20

Subject: **History** | Section: **Ancient** | Topic: **Vedic Age**

Consider the following statements about the Rigvedic period:

1. Irrigation from wells allowed agriculture to expand away from flood plains and strips on river margins into the present Punjab and Haryana plains having underground water levels reasonably close to the surface.
2. Draught-animal power was employed to draw up water out of the wells.

Which of the following information support/supports the above statements?

1. There is evidence in the Rigveda of the use of ashma chakra (stone pulley wheel) and ahava (strapped wooden pails) to draw up water.
2. Mention has been made in the Rigveda of the use of implements like parashu/kulisha (axe) and datra/sreni (sickle).
3. There is a history of the use of ox, even before the Rigveda, for ploughing the land and pulling the carts.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only	(b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 only	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. The Rigveda mentions **ashma chakra (stone pulley wheel)** and **ahava (wooden pails used for drawing water)**. These indicate the use of wells, ashma chakra and ahava for **lifting water, for irrigation far away from river flood plains**.

Statement 2 is incorrect. Implements like **parashu/kulisha** (axe) and **datra/sreni** (sickle) only show agricultural and forest-clearing activities. They **do not provide evidence about well irrigation or animal-powered water lifting**.

Statement 3 is correct. **Oxen** were already used for **ploughing fields and pulling carts** before and during the **Rigvedic period**. This indicates that **draught-animal power could be used to draw water from wells for irrigation**.

QUESTION 21

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Physical Geography - Geomorphology** | Topic: **Earthquake and Volcanism**

Tungurahua Volcano, which was declared a Global Geopark by UNESCO in 2025, is situated in which one among the following countries?

(a) Ecuador	(b) Peru
(c) Bolivia	(d) Colombia

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Option a is correct: Tungurahua volcano, which was declared a Global Geopark by UNESCO in 2025, is located in the Andes of **Ecuador**. The landscape features deep canyons, crystal-clear rivers, icy waterfalls, and towering rock walls, shaped by volcanic eruptions, tectonic uplift, and glacial activity over millennia. The Tungurahua volcano is still active and a key site for volcanological research.

QUESTION 22

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Protected Area Network** | Topic: **Tiger Reserve, Elephant Reserve, other species-specific reserves, etc.**

With reference to Madhav National Park, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It was declared a Tiger Reserve in India in 2025.
2. Sakhya Sagar, which is designated as a Ramsar Site, is situated within this National Park.
3. Its area is shared between Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Madhav National Park was officially declared as the **58th Tiger Reserve** in India by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in **March, 2025**. It is Madhya Pradesh's 9th tiger reserve. It was established initially as a national park in 1958.

Statement 2 is correct: **Sankhya Sagar**, declared a Ramsar site in 2022, is an artificial lake located within the Madhav National Park in Shivpuri district in Madhya Pradesh. The lake helps maintain the ecological balance of the Madhav National Park. As a Ramsar site, it is a wetland site designated internationally important by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Madhav National Park is located **entirely within the Shivpuri district of Madhya Pradesh**, not shared between the two states of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.

QUESTION 23

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Indian Geography** | Topic: **Climate, Monsoon**

With reference to the climate of Andaman and Nicobar Islands, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The climate can be defined as a humid, tropical coastal climate.
2. It receives rainfall from both South-west monsoon and North-east monsoon.
3. Maximum precipitation is between December and May.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Andaman and Nicobar Islands is the largest archipelago system in the Bay of Bengal. This lies in a crescent that stretches from Cape Negroid of Myanmar to Banda Arc of Sumatra (Indonesia).

Statement 1 is correct: The climate of the Andaman & Nicobar Islands can be defined as **humid, tropical, coastal climate**. The proximity to the equator and the sea ensures a hot, humid uniform climate. The islands are situated in the hot zone. The island experiences a Mean Relative Humidity of 79%.

Statement 2 is correct: Andaman and Nicobar Islands receive rainfall from **both the Southwest and Northeast monsoons**. It has no distinct winter season. The rainy season happens twice in a year:

- under the influence of southwest monsoon during mid-May to end of September
- under northeast monsoon during November to January

Statement 3 is incorrect: The maximum rainfall in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands is between **May to December** (and not between December and May). There are mainly two seasons in the island: the rainy season and summer season. Monsoon season is between May to August. Average annual rainfall in these Islands is 3000 mm. Summer Season is from March to May.

QUESTION 24

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Indian Geography** | Topic: **Physiography of India (Location, Division, Physiographic Regions)**

Which of the following geographical features or phenomena is/are associated with the Peninsular Block of India?

1. Submergence of parts of the western coast due to tectonic activity
2. Presence of residual mountain ranges such as the Veliconda hills and Mahendragiri hills
3. Deep, V-shaped river valleys formed by fast-flowing rivers

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Rising from the height of 150 m above the river plains up to an elevation of 600-900 m is the irregular triangle known as the Peninsular plateau.

Statement 1 is correct: This Peninsular plateau has undergone recurrent phases of upliftment and submergence accompanied by crustal faulting and fractures. Since the Cambrian period, the Peninsula has been standing like a rigid block with the exception of some of its western coast which is submerged beneath the sea and some other parts changed due to tectonic activity without affecting the original basement.

Statement 2 is correct: As a part of the Indo-Australian Plate, the Peninsular block has been subjected to various vertical movements and block faulting. The Peninsula mostly consists of relict and residual mountains like the Aravali hills, the Nallamala hills, the Javadi hills, the **Veliconda hills**, the Palkonda range and the **Mahendragiri hills**, etc.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The Peninsular drainage system is older than the Himalayan one. Unlike the youthful Himalayan rivers (Ganga, Indus, Brahmaputra etc.) that form deep V-shaped valleys, Peninsular rivers are in a mature stage and generally form through broad, shallow valleys.

QUESTION 25

Subject: Economy | Section: Infrastructure | Topic: Transport

Consider the following statements with reference to the Sagarmala Programme of the Government of India:

- I. The Sagarmala Programme seeks to achieve port-led economic growth through cost-effective and sustainable coastal infrastructure.
- II. The success of the Sagarmala Programme is reflected in significant growth in coastal and inland waterway shipping, along with improved global port rankings.
- III. Sagarmala 2.0 aims to position India as global maritime innovation hub aligned with Atmanirbhar Bharat and Viksit Bharat 2047 visions.

Which of the following relationships among the above statements is/are correct?

1. Statement II validates the effectiveness of the strategies envisioned in statement I.
2. Statement III extends the objectives of statement I by embedding them into a future-oriented innovation framework.
3. Statement I contradicts statement III by focusing only on traditional infrastructure instead of modern innovation.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct: The Sagarmala Programme, launched in March 2015, is the flagship initiative of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways, aimed at revolutionizing India's maritime sector and promoting port-led development.

Statement II is correct and validates the effectiveness of the strategies envisioned in Statement I: The success of the Sagarmala Programme reflects sustained progress in strengthening port infrastructure, improving connectivity, operational performance and stronger global competitiveness of Indian ports.

Record Cargo Handling: India's major ports have collectively handled a record 915.17 million tonnes (MT) of cargo during FY 2025–26.

Operational Efficiency: Average vessel turnaround time declined significantly from 96 hours in 2014 to 49.5 hours in 2025.

Global Recognition: Indian ports have strengthened their global presence, with 9 ports ranking among the world's top 100.

Statement III is correct and extends the objectives of Statement I: Sagarmala 2.0, the next phase of the Sagarmala Programme, builds upon its achievements while adopting a broader and more integrated national vision for the maritime sector outlined in MIV (Maritime India Vision) 2030 and MAKV (Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision) 2047.

Statement I does not contradict Statement III as it also focuses on modern innovation: modernizing and building ports, improving port connectivity while encouraging investment from both the public and private sectors.

QUESTION 26

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Biodiversity & Conservation** | Topic: **Major Species (Keystone, Indicator, Invasive, Endemic, etc.)**

Consider the following statements about *Rhynchosstylis retusa* (Foftail orchid):

1. It is an epiphytic orchid.
2. The species is endemic to North-east India.
3. It is the State flower of Arunachal Pradesh and Assam.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: *Rhynchosstylis retusa* (also called foftail orchid) is an **epiphytic orchid**. The plant is an epiphyte growing on tree trunks in open forests or at forest margins at elevations of 300–1,500 m.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The *Rhynchosstylis retusa* (Foftail Orchid) is **not endemic to North-east India** and is native to broad regions across South and Southeast Asia. It can be found in Bhutan, Cambodia, China, India, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Thailand, and Vietnam.

Statement 3 is correct: *Rhynchosstylis retusa* is recognized as the **state flower of Arunachal Pradesh and Assam**. In Assam, it is locally called Kapou phul.

QUESTION 27

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **Architecture**

Which one of the following statements with regard to the Moidams, built by the Tai-Ahom kingdom and inscribed as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO, is/are correct?

1. They acted as army fortresses.
2. They were recreation centres of the Royals and Nobles.
3. They were burial grounds of the Royals and Nobles.
4. They were battle drill centres of the Royals and Nobles.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 3
(c) 3 only	(d) 2 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Moidams do not act as army fortresses; they are sacred burial mounds of the Ahom kings, queens, and nobility.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Moidams were not recreation centers. They are a sacred mound-burial system constructed by the Tai-Ahom dynasty in Assam.

Statement 3 is correct: Moidams – the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty are a **royal mound burial necropolis** established by the Tai-Ahom in northeastern India. Moidams is situated in the foothills of the Patkai Ranges in eastern Assam. These burial mounds are considered sacred by the Tai-Ahom and reflect their unique funerary practices. The Tai-Ahom people arrived in Assam in the 13th century, establishing **Charaideo** as their first city and the site of the royal necropolis.

Statement 4 is incorrect: Moidams were not battle drill centres. Serving as royal necropolises, these dome-shaped structures—often compared to the pyramids of Egypt—were resting places for Ahom kings, queens, and nobles.

QUESTION 28

Subject: International Relations | Section: Global Institutions & Agreements | Topic: International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)

At the United Nations Ocean Conference (UNOC) held in June, 2025 in France, the Food and Agricultural Organization (FAO) of the United Nations demonstrated its leading voice on marine and ocean issues, especially on sustainable fisheries and aquaculture for resilient livelihood and "Blue Transformation".

Which of the following combinations about the "Four Betters" proposed by FAO for "Blue Transformation" is correct?

(a) Better production, better nutrition, better environment and better ocean	(b) Better production, better nutrition, better environment and better life
(c) Better coral reefs, better nutrition, better environment and better life	(d) Better estuaries, better nutrition, better environment and better mangrove vegetation

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Option b is correct: At the 3rd United Nations Ocean Conference held in Nice, France, in June 2025, the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) proposed its vision of "Blue Transformation," a framework built upon the "Four Betters" designed to achieve sustainable aquatic food systems and global food security: **better production, better nutrition, a better environment, and a better life** – leaving no one behind.

QUESTION 29

Subject: Geography | Section: World Geography | Topic: Rivers, Lakes

Which of the following statements with reference to Lake Turkana is/are correct?

1. It is the largest desert lake in the world.
2. The lake is situated in South Sudan along the eastern fringe of the Sahara desert.
3. The lake is listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site and is also referred to as the 'Jade Sea'.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Lake Turkana is the most saline lake in East Africa and the **largest desert lake in the world**, surrounded by an arid, seemingly extraterrestrial landscape.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Lake Turkana is located in **northern Kenya**, extending into **Ethiopia**. It is one of eight major lakes along the Kenyan part of the Rift Valley.

Statement 3 is correct: Lake Turkana is a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**. It was inscribed in 1997 as Lake Turkana National Parks. It is Africa's fourth largest lake, fondly called the **Jade Sea** because of its breathtaking color.

QUESTION 30

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **International Environmental Conventions, Organisations & Laws** | Topic: **Climate Change (UNFCCC, UNEP, REDD, etc.)**

Which one of the following is the first Plan Vivo certified Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (REDD+) project in India?

(a) Uttarakhand REDD+ project	(b) ICFRE-ICIMOD Transboundary REDD+ project in North-Eastern Himalayas
(c) Khasi Hills Community REDD+ project	(d) Sikkim Mamley Kamrang Community REDD+ project

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Option c is correct: India's first Plan Vivo-certified REDD+ project is the **Khasi Hills Community REDD+ Project in Meghalaya**. Initiated in 2011, it protects and restores 27,000 ha of cloud forest, in addition to preserving sacred groves and watersheds.

QUESTION 31

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Climate Change** | Topic: **Tackling Climate Change**

Consider the following statements with reference to India's response to climate change:

I. India's Long-Term Low Emission Development Strategy (LT-LEDS) is a crucial tool for achieving net-zero emissions by 2070.

II. India's 4th Biennial Update Report (BUR-4) submitted in December, 2024 recorded around 8% decrease in Greenhouse gas emissions in 2020 over 2019.

III. Climate-resilient development necessarily depends on quick and short-term achievement of emission reduction targets.

Which of the following relationships among the above statements is/are correct?

- Statement I is empirically supported by statement II.
- Statement III contradicts the approach implicit in statement I.
- Statement I and statement III together establish the premise of long-term sustainability.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
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(c) 2 and 3

(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option b is the correct answer.**

Statement I is correct: India's Long-Term Low Greenhouse Gas Emission Development Strategies (LT-LEDS), submitted to the UNFCCC in November 2022, reaffirms India's target to achieve net-zero emissions by 2070.

Statement II is correct: As per the PIB release for India's 4th Biennial Update Report (BUR-4) submitted on December 30, 2024, India's GHG emissions decreased by 7.93% (around 8%) in 2020 with respect to 2019.

Statement III is incorrect: India's climate policy explicitly rejects absolute, short-term emission constraints that compromise developmental needs. It is based on long-term, equitable, and sustainable growth under the principle of Common But Differentiated Responsibilities (CBDR-RC).

Statement I is empirically supported by Statement II is correct: Statement I outlines the long-term strategic tool (LT-LEDS) for emission reduction. Statement II provides the empirical, real-world inventory data from the BUR-4 proving that India is actively decoupling economic progress from emissions.

Statement III contradicts the approach implicit in Statement I is correct: Statement I relies on a long-term, progressive transition toward 2070. Statement III mandates that climate resilience necessarily depends on quick and short-term achievements, directly contradicting the phased, multi-decadal approach of the LT-LEDS.

QUESTION 32

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Biodiversity & Conservation** | Topic: **Wildlife Conservation (Tiger, Elephant, Lion, Rhino, Crocodile, Vulture, Tortoise, Dolphin, etc.)**

With respect to the Western Hoolock Gibbons, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A Sanctuary in North-east India is home to this ape species listed as Endangered in the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.
2. They have specialized brachiation and can easily swing between trees.
3. They possess a strong and heavy build like gorillas, yet are remarkably agile tree climbers.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only

(b) 1 and 2

(c) 2 and 3

(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option b is the correct answer.**

Statement 1 is correct: The **Hoollongapar Gibbon Sanctuary in Assam** (North-east India) is the premier sanctuary dedicated to this species. The Western Hoolock Gibbon (*Hoolock hoolock*) is officially listed as **Endangered** on the IUCN Red List.

Statement 2 is correct: As lesser apes, gibbons are famous for **brachiation** – a specialized arm-swinging locomotion through the forest canopy enabled by their elongated arms and highly flexible ball-and-socket shoulder joints.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Unlike massive, heavy-built great apes like gorillas, Hoolock Gibbons are **small, slender, and lightweight** (weighing only 6–9 kg), an evolutionary adaptation essential for their agile, arboreal lifestyle.

QUESTION 33

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Ecology & Ecosystem** | Topic: **Aquatic Ecosystem and Life (Aquatic Ecosystem, Maritime Zones, Corals, Mangrove, Marine Vegetation)**

Which of the following best explain(s) the rationale for protecting mangrove ecosystems in the context of climate resilience?

1. Mangroves reduce tidal energy and store freshwater, making them ideal sites for paddy cultivation in saline estuarine belts.
2. Their salt-sensitive roots filter seawater, making mangroves key to converting coastal land into freshwater aquaculture zones.
3. By withstanding tidal surges and offering biomass resources, mangroves function both as natural bio-shields and livelihood bases for rural communities.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Mangroves are intertidal ecosystems and do not store freshwater for traditional paddy cultivation. Clearing mangroves for agriculture causes seawater to ruin adjacent farmlands.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Mangroves are **salt-tolerant halophytes**, not salt-sensitive. Clearing mangroves to create commercial aquaculture is a leading cause of coastal degradation.

Statement 3 is correct: Mangroves reduce storm damage by up to 70%, acting as vital **natural bio-shields** against tidal surges. Concurrently, they support over 120 million people and nurture 80% of young fish, crabs, and shrimp, serving as resilient **livelihood bases** for coastal rural communities.

QUESTION 34

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Infrastructure** | Topic: **Transport**

In what way(s) does the Vizhinjam International Seaport represent a structural shift in India's maritime trade and logistics policy?

1. By functioning exclusively as a domestic cargo hub to reduce reliance on coastal shipping and eliminate the need for foreign collaborations.
2. By focusing primarily on passenger cruise tourism and heritage shipping to increase Kerala's profile as a maritime heritage destination.
3. By leveraging its natural deep draft and strategic location to reduce dependence on foreign trans-shipment ports, and enhance revenue retention, reposition India in regional maritime trade.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Vizhinjam is explicitly developed as a premier **International Transshipment Hub** rather than an exclusive domestic cargo hub.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Vizhinjam is entirely focused on **industrial container logistics and cargo transshipment** (handling mega container ships, extending container berths, and managing up to 5.7 million TEUs).

Statement 3 is correct: Vizhinjam leverages its inherent locational advantages (just 10 nautical miles from the international shipping route) and its **natural deep draft of 18m** close to shore. This directly reduces India's historical dependence on foreign transshipment hubs (like Colombo) for routing Indian origin cargo, thereby enhancing domestic revenue retention and boosting India's maritime competitiveness.

QUESTION 35

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Indian Geography** | Topic: **Drainage System, Rivers, River Interlinking**

Identify the river of the Indian sub-continent on the basis of the following information:

1. It has an antecedent drainage system.
2. It flows through three countries.
3. It originates in the Tibetan Plateau and is an important river for irrigation.
4. It does not form distributaries.

Select the answer from the following:

(a) Brahmaputra	(b) Indus
(c) Sutlej	(d) Teesta

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Option a is incorrect: Brahmaputra is an antecedent river and flows through China/Tibet, India and Bangladesh. However, in its lower course, especially in Bangladesh, it forms several channels and distributaries as part of the Ganga-Brahmaputra delta system.

Option b is incorrect: Indus is an antecedent river and flows through China/Tibet, India and Pakistan. However, the Indus forms a delta near the Arabian Sea, where it develops distributary channels.

Option c is correct: **Sutlej** is an antecedent river because it cuts across the Himalayas through deep gorges. It originates near the Rakshastal-Mansarovar region in Tibet and flows through China/Tibet, India and Pakistan. It is highly important for irrigation and hydroelectricity. Since Sutlej is a tributary of the Indus system and **does not independently form a delta or distributaries**.

Option d is incorrect: Teesta mainly flows through India and Bangladesh, not three countries. It also does not originate in the Tibetan Plateau like Sutlej.

QUESTION 36

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Indian Geography** | Topic: **Physiography of India (Location, Division, Physiographic Regions)**

Which of the following with reference to Indian States is/are not correct?

1. Uttar Pradesh shares its boundary with the highest number of other Indian States.
2. Rajasthan shares the longest international border among all Indian States.
3. Sikkim is the only State that shares its boundary with just one other Indian State.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Uttar Pradesh shares its borders with the highest number of other Indian States. It touches exactly 8 states (Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Bihar) plus 1 Union Territory (Delhi).

Statement 2 is incorrect: Rajasthan does not share the longest international border among Indian states. **West Bengal** shares the longest international border (around 2,217 km with Bangladesh).

Statement 3 is incorrect: Sikkim is not the only state that shares its boundary with just one other Indian state. **Meghalaya** also shares its domestic land border exclusively with just one Indian state (Assam).

QUESTION 37

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Biodiversity & Conservation** | Topic: **Wildlife Conservation (Tiger, Elephant, Lion, Rhino, Crocodile, Vulture, Tortoise, Dolphin, etc.)**

Which of the following statements with regard to the arrival of Amur Falcons at Doyang Lake in Nagaland each year from Mongolia is/are correct?

1. It showcases how sustained local conservation efforts can contribute to the arrival and protection of international migratory birds.
2. It reflects the global success of advanced tracking technologies that guide migratory birds back to their stopover sites.
3. It confirms that Amur Falcons have adapted to permanent residency in India due to favourable habitat changes.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: The arrival of Amur Falcons at Doyang Lake, Nagaland shows the success of **community-based conservation**. Earlier, local people hunted these birds, but after awareness campaigns by wildlife activists, Church groups, forest officials and local communities, hunting stopped and the birds are now protected.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Satellite tracking chips help scientists track and study the migration route of Amur Falcons. But they **do not guide the birds back** to their stopover sites. The birds return naturally due to their migratory instinct.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Amur Falcons have **not become permanent residents** of India. They only use Nagaland as a temporary stop during migration from Mongolia/northern China/eastern Russia towards South Africa.

QUESTION 38

Subject: **Agriculture** | Section: **Agricultural Economics & Policies** | Topic: **Agriculture Government Schemes and Policies**

Which among the following is/are the objective(s) of the Rainfed Area Development (RAD) initiative under the National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA)?

1. Encouraging monoculture in rainfed areas
2. Increasing rice cultivation in irrigated regions
3. Enhancing productivity and minimising climatic risks through Integrated Farming Systems (IFS)

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: RAD aims at promoting location-specific improved agronomic practices through **crop diversification** and progressive adoption of multi-cropping systems. It explicitly moves away from single-crop vulnerability, meaning it **discourages monoculture**.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The mandate of the scheme is strictly bounded within **rainfed/dry-land areas** (covering blocks having more than 60% rainfed uplands). It does not focus on expanding rice cultivation within already well-irrigated regions.

Statement 3 is correct: The core objective is to make agriculture more productive and climate-resilient by promoting location-specific **Integrated Farming Systems (IFS)**, thereby maximizing farm returns and minimizing the risk of total crop failure during extreme weather events.

QUESTION 39

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **External Sector** | Topic: **Trade (Exports, Imports, FDI, FII, etc.)**

Which of the following is/are the most significant implication(s) of obtaining Oeko-Tex certification for Eri Silk in the global textile industry?

1. It allows Indian exporters to compete in high-end markets that prioritise chemical-free products.
2. It confirms that Eri Silk meets international safety, environmental, and quality standards, enabling its entry into premium eco-conscious markets.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2	(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Oeko-Tex certification helps Indian exporters compete in high-end global textile markets because it assures buyers that Eri Silk is safe, eco-friendly and free from harmful chemicals.

Statement 2 is correct: Oeko-Tex certification confirms that Eri Silk meets international safety and quality standards. It increases confidence among international buyers and helps Eri Silk enter premium eco-conscious markets.

QUESTION 40

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **World Geography** | Topic: **Straits, Channels, Oceans, Seas, Gulfs, Bays**

Ships from which of the following countries have to cross the Strait of Hormuz to reach out to the Indian Ocean?

1. Bahrain
2. Syria
3. Qatar
4. Egypt

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 3 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Option 1 is correct: Bahrain lies inside the Persian Gulf. Any ship moving from Bahrain towards the Indian Ocean/Arabian Sea has to pass through the **Strait of Hormuz**.

Option 2 is incorrect: Syria lies on the Mediterranean Sea. Ships from Syria would move through the Suez Canal and Red Sea route to reach the Indian Ocean, not through the Strait of Hormuz.

Option 3 is correct: Qatar also lies inside the Persian Gulf. Therefore, ships from Qatar must cross the **Strait of Hormuz** to come out towards the Gulf of Oman, Arabian Sea and Indian Ocean.

Option 4 is incorrect: Egypt is connected to the Indian Ocean route through the Suez Canal → Red Sea → Bab-el-Mandeb → Arabian Sea. It does not need to cross the Strait of Hormuz.

QUESTION 41

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *Global Institutions & Agreements* | Topic: *International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)*

Match List I with List II and select the answer using the code given below the Lists:

List I (INTERPOL Notice)	List II (Description)
A. Silver Notice	1. To seek information on unidentified bodies
B. Blue Notice	2. To collect additional information about a person's identity, location, or activities in relation to a criminal investigation
C. Black Notice	3. To provide warning about a person's criminal activities, where the person is considered to be a possible threat to public safety
D. Green Notice	4. To identify and trace criminal assets

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a) 3 1 2 4				
(b) 3 2 1 4				
(c) 4 2 1 3				
(d) 4 1 2 3				

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

A-4: The **Silver Notice** is used to identify, locate, and trace criminally obtained assets such as property, vehicles, financial accounts, or businesses linked to criminal activity.

B-2: The **Blue Notice** helps law enforcement agencies gather further information about a person connected with a criminal investigation.

C-1: The **Black Notice** is issued to seek information regarding unidentified bodies discovered in different countries.

D-3: The **Green Notice** is issued to warn member countries about individuals who may pose a threat due to prior criminal behaviour.

QUESTION 42

Subject: *Environment* | Section: *Indian Government Laws & Organisations* | Topic: *NGT, PCB, FSI, NBWL, other bodies, etc.*

Which of the following statements in relation to NIRANTAR (National Institute for Research and Application of Natural Resources to Transform, Adapt and Build Resilience), a platform of institutions under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is/are correct?

1. Ecosystem Survey and Analysis is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Botanical Survey of India, Kolkata.
2. Research and Management of Ecosystem Service is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Central Zoo Authority, New Delhi.

3. Capacity Development Support is a vertical under this platform, the lead institute of which is Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 only	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Ecosystem Survey & Analysis is one of the thematic verticals under NIRANTAR, and its lead institute is the **Botanical Survey of India**.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Research and Management of Ecosystem Service is a vertical under NIRANTAR. However, its lead institute is the **Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education** headquartered in Dehradun, not the Central Zoo Authority.

Statement 3 is correct: Capacity Development Support is another thematic vertical under NIRANTAR, led by the **Indian Institute of Forest Management**, Bhopal.

QUESTION 43

Subject: **International Relations** | Section: **India's Foreign Policy & Bilateral Relations** | Topic: **India and the World (USA, Russia, Middle East, Africa, etc.)**

The Chancellor of the Federal Republic of Germany visited India in January, 2026. Which of the following is/are not correct in terms of outcomes of this visit?

1. Signing of a Memorandum of Understanding between the All India Institute of Ayurveda and the University of Hamburg
2. Signing of a Memorandum of Understanding on Youth Hockey Development between Hockey India and the German Hockey Federation
3. Establishment of a bilateral dialogue mechanism on the Indo-Pacific
4. Opening of an Honorary Consul of Germany in Lucknow

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 2 and 3	(b) 1 and 4
(c) 3 and 4	(d) 1 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The agreement on traditional medicine was signed between the All India Institute of Ayurveda and **Charite University, Germany**, not the University of Hamburg.

Statement 2 is correct: A Memorandum of Understanding on Youth Hockey Development was signed between Hockey India and the German Hockey Federation.

Statement 3 is correct: One of the major announcements during the visit was the establishment of a bilateral dialogue mechanism on the Indo-Pacific.

Statement 4 is incorrect: The announcement related to the opening of an Honorary Consul of Germany in **Ahmedabad**, not Lucknow.

QUESTION 44

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Emerging & Information Technologies** | Topic: **Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI**

Which of the following statements about DHRUV64 is/are correct?

1. It is the third chip fabricated under the DIR-V Programme with an overall aim to enable the creation of microprocessors for India.
2. It is India's first homegrown 1.0 GHz, 64-bit dual-core microprocessor.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2	(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: DHRUV64 is the **third chip fabricated under the DIR-V Programme**. The sequence under the DIR-V initiative includes: THEJAS32 → THEJAS64 → DHRUV64.

Statement 2 is correct: DHRUV64 has been officially described as **India's first indigenous 1.0 GHz, 64-bit dual-core microprocessor**. It has been developed by C-DAC under the Microprocessor Development Programme (MDP).

QUESTION 45

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

The Bureau of Indian Standard (BIS) recently introduced a national standard to test and assess bomb disposal system. Which of the following statements with regard to this system is/are correct?

1. The new standard is known as IS 19445: 2025.
2. It will improve interoperability of equipment across agencies.
3. It was developed by TBRL, DRDO in collaboration with the 30th Central Scientific Research Institute, Russia.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: The newly introduced national standard for bomb disposal systems has officially been designated as **IS 19445:2025**.

Statement 2 is correct: One of the stated objectives of IS 19445:2025 is to improve the reliability and **interoperability** of bomb disposal equipment across agencies.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The standard was developed through a consensus-based process under the Arms and Ammunition for Civilian Use Sectional Committee (PGD 28) of BIS. There was **no collaboration** mentioned with the 30th Central Scientific Research Institute, Russia.

QUESTION 46

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Basic Sciences** | Topic: **General Science - Physics, Chemistry, and Miscellaneous**

'X', born in the UK, was conferred the Nobel Prize in 2025. He was a professor in an American university when this prize was announced. Identify 'X':

(a) Michel H. Devoret	(b) Richard Robson
-----------------------	--------------------

(c) John Clarke

(d) Joel Mokyr

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option c is the correct answer.**

The 2025 Nobel Prize in Physics was awarded jointly to **John Clarke**, Michel H. Devoret, and John M. Martinis for the discovery of macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit.

John Clarke was born in **Cambridge, United Kingdom**, and at the time of the Nobel Prize announcement, he was affiliated with the **University of California, Berkeley, USA**.

Michel H. Devoret was born in **France**, not in the United Kingdom.

Richard Robson received recognition in the field of **Chemistry**.

Joel Mokyr was recognised for contributions to **economic history**.

QUESTION 47

Subject: History | Section: Art & Culture | Topic: GI Tags, Awards & Honours

Which of the following statements with regard to the Grand Slam Tennis Tournaments is/are correct?

1. The tournaments have a shared governance structure establishing the partnership among the four Grand Slam tournaments.
2. They are open for entry to all internationally ranked tennis players above the age of 14.
3. There is a limitation on the number of 'Wild Cards' a player may receive to compete in a Grand Slam Tournament.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option c is the correct answer.**

Statement 1 is correct: The Grand Slam Rules clearly state that Grand Slam Tennis (GST) functions through a **shared governance structure** involving the four Grand Slam tournaments.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The rules specify that Grand Slam tournaments are open to internationally ranked players with a ranking of 500 or better. The rules only state that players **under the age of 14 are not eligible**. This does not mean that every player above 14 automatically becomes eligible.

Statement 3 is incorrect: The Grand Slam Rules explicitly provide that **"There shall be no limitation as to the number of Wild Cards a player may receive to compete in the Grand Slam Tournaments."**

QUESTION 48

Subject: Science & Technology | Section: Emerging & Information Technologies | Topic: Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI

Which one of the following pairs of semiconductor plants in India and their locations is not correctly matched?

	Plant	Location
(a)	CG Power and Industrial Solutions Pvt. Ltd. in partnership with Renesas Electronics and STARS Microelectronics Gujarat	(b) Tata Semiconductor Assembly and Test Pvt. Ltd. Assam

(c) HCL-Foxconn Joint Venture India Chip Ltd. | Madhya Pradesh

(d) SicSem Pvt. Ltd. | Odisha

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Pair a is correct: CG Power is establishing a semiconductor OSAT unit at **Sanand, Gujarat**.

Pair b is correct: Tata Semiconductor Assembly and Test Pvt. Ltd. is setting up India's first indigenous semiconductor assembly and test facility at **Jagiroad, Assam**.

Pair c is incorrect: India Chip Pvt. Ltd. is being established at the **Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA), Uttar Pradesh**, not Madhya Pradesh.

Pair d is correct: SiCSem Private Limited is setting up India's first commercial Silicon Carbide (SiC) compound semiconductor fabrication facility at **Info Valley, Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.

QUESTION 49

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Basic Sciences** | Topic: **General Science - Physics, Chemistry, and Miscellaneous**

Which of the following statements with regard to India's indigenous new high resolution weather model, the 'Bharat Forecast System,' is/are correct?

1. Its objective is to generate forecasts at the Panchayats cluster level.
2. It was developed by IIT Delhi.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: The Bharat Forecast System (BharatFS) was specifically developed to generate localized forecasts at the **cluster of Panchayats/villages level**. With its 6 km horizontal resolution, the model demonstrated nearly 30% improvement in forecasting extreme rainfall events.

Statement 2 is incorrect: BharatFS was developed primarily by scientists from **Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM-Pune)**, National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting (NCMRWF-Noida) and India Meteorological Department (IMD). It was **not developed by IIT Delhi**.

QUESTION 50

Subject: **History** | Section: **Art & Culture** | Topic: **GI Tags, Awards & Honours**

Consider the following statements with regard to the film 'Boong':

1. The film has recently won the British Academy of Film and Television Arts (BAFTA) Award in the Children's and Family Film category.
2. The film is directed by Lakshmipriya Devi.
3. This is the first Indian film to win a BAFTA award in the Children's and Family Film category.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 2 only

(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Boong won the **BAFTA Award for Best Children's and Family Film** at the 2026 BAFTA Awards.

Statement 2 is correct: The film was directed by **Lakshmipriya Devi**.

Statement 3 is correct: Boong became the **first Indian film** to win a BAFTA Award in the Children's and Family Film category.

QUESTION 51

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Emerging & Information Technologies** | Topic: **Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI**

Which of the following statements regarding the features of blockchain technology are correct?

1. Records stored in the database may be made visible to relevant stakeholders without risk of alteration.
2. Copies of the entire database are stored on multiple computers on a network, syncing within seconds.
3. Consortium blockchain is a blend of public and private blockchains allowing selective data access.
4. Mathematical algorithms make it impossible to change or delete any data once recorded and accepted.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 3	(b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 4	(d) 1 and 4 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. Blockchain technology provides transparency along with data security. Records can be accessed by authorised participants but cannot be easily altered.

Statement 2 is correct. Blockchain functions as a **distributed database**. Identical copies are maintained on many computers or nodes connected through a network, synchronised within seconds or minutes.

Statement 3 is incorrect. A **consortium blockchain** is a semi-decentralised blockchain system governed jointly by multiple organisations. In contrast, a **hybrid blockchain** combines features of both public and private blockchains and allows selective access to data.

Statement 4 is correct. **Immutability** is one of the most important features of blockchain technology. Once a transaction is verified and added to the chain, altering or deleting it is practically impossible.

QUESTION 52

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Sectors of Economy** | Topic: **Services**

An e-commerce revenue model where the seller has control over pricing but doesn't keep products in stock and instead transfers customer orders and shipment details to a third-party supplier, who then ships the goods directly to the customer, is called:

(a) Dropshipping Model	(b) Affiliate Revenue Model
(c) Transaction Fee Revenue Model	(d) Agency Revenue Model

Correct Answer: Option (A)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Dropshipping is a business model that lets you sell products without stocking or shipping them yourself. You choose items from a third-party supplier, list them in your store and once someone places an order, the supplier handles fulfillment. The product goes directly from their warehouse to your customer's door.

QUESTION 53

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Banking, NPA**

Which one of the following correctly represents the three key sub-indices of the Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (a) Credit access, Insurance depth, and Pension coverage | (b) Banking access, GDP contribution, and Financial literacy |
| (c) Access, Usage, and Quality | (d) Access, Affordability, and Transparency |

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index) was launched by the Reserve Bank of India in 2021. It is based on three major sub-indices namely "**Access**", "**Usage**" and "**Quality**".

QUESTION 54

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Sectors of Economy** | Topic: **Services**

Which one of the following best describes the key objective of India's 'Open Network for Digital Commerce' (ONDC) initiative?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (a) To allow government control over all digital commerce transactions | (b) To replace private e-commerce players |
| (c) To break the dominance of large e-commerce platforms by enabling interoperability across networks | (d) To mandate UPI-based payments for all online transactions |

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) is an initiative launched by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) in April 2022. The core objective of ONDC is to **reduce the dominance of a few large e-commerce platforms** and create a level playing field for all participants, especially MSMEs, local retailers, startups and small businesses. Through **interoperability**, buyers and sellers using different applications can seamlessly interact and transact with each other.

QUESTION 55

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Money (Evolution, Types, Digital Currency, Crypto, etc.)**

Which one of the following statements about Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and Central Bank Digital Currency (Digital Rupee) is not correct?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (a) UPI is a real-time payment system but Digital Rupee is akin to sovereign paper currency. | (b) In case of UPI, settlement for end users happens instantly as the money gets immediately debited or credited but in case of Digital Rupee, there is no settlement as the wallet balance gets transferred to another wallet. |
|--|---|

(c) UPI transactions are recorded by banks and reflected in bank statements but in case of Digital Rupee, no data is captured in bank statements as transactions are from one wallet to another.

(d) In both the cases (UPI and Digital Rupee), the liability lies with the users and their respective banks.

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Option a is correct. UPI is a real-time payment system. The Digital Rupee (CBDC) is similar to sovereign paper currency issued by the RBI.

Option b is correct. In UPI transactions, money is debited and credited instantly between bank accounts. In contrast, CBDC transactions involve direct transfer of wallet balances, like transfer of physical cash.

Option c is correct. UPI transactions are routed through banks and reflected in bank statements. CBDC wallet-to-wallet transactions do not require bank intermediation.

Option d is incorrect. In UPI, the liability is linked to the users' bank accounts and commercial banks. However, in the case of **Digital Rupee, the liability lies with the central bank, i.e., the Reserve Bank of India**, since CBDC is sovereign digital currency issued directly by the RBI.

QUESTION 56

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Financial Markets**

Which of the following statements about Real-World Assets (RWA) Tokenization are correct?

1. Tokenization is the process of turning real world assets into digital tokens using blockchain technology.
2. Tokenization of real world assets offers 24×7 access, promoting financial inclusion.
3. Tokenization of real world assets will allow the access to high growth investment opportunities for individuals in India.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 2 only

(d) 1 and 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. Tokenization refers to the process of converting ownership rights of real-world assets into digital tokens on a blockchain network.

Statement 2 is correct. Tokenization enables **24×7 market access** because blockchain-based platforms operate continuously. It allows investors from different regions to participate with lower entry barriers through fractional ownership.

Statement 3 is correct. RWA tokenization can provide Indian investors access to **high-growth investment opportunities** that were traditionally available only to institutional investors or high-net-worth individuals.

QUESTION 57

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Financial Markets**

A bond whose proceeds are used only to finance or refinance a combination of both environmental and social projects is called:

(a) Green Bond

(b) Social Bond

(c) Sustainability Bond

(d) Sovereign Bond

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

A **Sustainability Bond** is a financial instrument whose proceeds are used to finance or refinance a **combination of both environmental and social projects**. Environmental projects may include renewable energy, clean transportation, pollution control, while social projects may include affordable housing, healthcare, education and employment generation.

QUESTION 58

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Financial Markets**

Which of the following statements about M1xchange's role in Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) financing is/are correct?

1. M1xchange provides collateral based loans to MSMEs.
2. M1xchange facilitates discounting of invoices and Bills of Exchange for MSMEs.
3. M1xchange functions as a credit rating agency for MSMEs.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect. M1xchange is an RBI-approved **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS)** platform. It does not primarily provide collateral-based loans. Instead, it offers **collateral-free invoice financing**.

Statement 2 is correct. It facilitates **discounting of invoices and bills of exchange** raised by MSMEs against corporate buyers and government entities.

Statement 3 is incorrect. M1xchange is **not a credit rating agency**. It operates as a digital marketplace connecting MSMEs, buyers and financiers for invoice discounting.

QUESTION 59

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Fiscal Policy, Budget, Taxation** | Topic: **Fiscal Policy**

Which one of the following best describes the 'Crowding Out Effect' in the context of fiscal policy?

(a) A situation where private investment increases due to increased Government spending	(b) A situation where Government borrowing leads to higher interest rates, which reduces private investment
(c) A situation where an increase in taxes leads to increased private sector investment	(d) A situation where Government spending has no impact on aggregate demand

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

When the government runs a large fiscal deficit, it borrows heavily from the domestic financial market. This increases the demand for loanable funds. As government borrowing rises, **real interest rates tend to increase**. Higher interest rates make borrowing more expensive for private businesses. This reduction in private investment due to excessive government borrowing is known as the **crowding out effect**.

QUESTION 60

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Economic Geography** | Topic: **Critical and Strategic Minerals (Lithium, Cobalt, Titanium, KABIL, REEs, etc.)**

Which of the following statements about Rare Earth Elements (REEs) and Critical Minerals is/are correct?

1. Modern Technological innovations including Artificial Intelligence, robotics and space exploration extensively utilise Rare Earth Elements (REEs).
2. China has the highest share in mining of REEs followed by India.
3. The Government of India launched the National Critical Mineral Mission (NCMM) in 2025 to establish a robust framework for self-reliance in the critical mineral sector.
4. Rare Earth Elements are a set of 13 metallic elements.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 3 only	(b) 3 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4	(d) 1, 2 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct. Rare Earth Elements are extensively used in modern technologies such as AI, robotics, semiconductors, electric vehicles, wind turbines, satellites, defence systems, and space exploration.

Statement 2 is incorrect. China has the largest share in global reserves and production of REEs, but **India is not the second-largest producer**. India has the third-largest reserves but its actual production is less than one percent of global output.

Statement 3 is correct. The Government of India launched the **National Critical Mineral Mission (NCMM) in 2025**.

Statement 4 is incorrect. Rare Earth Elements are a group of **17 elements** (15 lanthanides plus scandium and yttrium), not 13.

QUESTION 61

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Insurance and Pension**

Which of the following statements about insurance in aviation sector is/are correct?

1. 'Aviation Hull Insurance' covers the physical aircraft, including the body, engine, and on-board equipment.
2. Under the Montreal Convention, adopted in 1999 by over 130 countries, including India, airlines are strictly liable to pay compensation to the family/nominee of every deceased passenger without requiring the family to prove fault.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2	(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Aircraft hull insurance cover is designed to protect against the physical loss of or damage to aircraft, including engines and other fitted parts.

Statement 2 is correct: The **Montreal Convention** was adopted in 1999. India is a signatory. Under MC99, airlines are **strictly liable** to pay a specified amount of compensation to the families of deceased passengers **without anyone needing to prove fault**. Airlines are strictly liable for up to 1,51,880 'Special Drawing Rights (SDR)', amounting to over \$2,07,000 per passenger.

QUESTION 62

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Financial Markets**

Which of the following statements about Crowdfunding is/are correct?

1. Crowdfunding is solicitation of funds (small amount) from multiple investors through a web-based platform or social networking site for a specific project.
2. Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) are able to raise funds at lower cost of capital without undergoing rigorous procedures.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2	(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Crowdfunding is solicitation of funds (small amount) from multiple investors through a web-based platform or social networking site for a specific project, business venture or social cause.

Statement 2 is correct: Crowdfunding provides a much needed new mode of financing for start-ups and the SMEs sector. SMEs are able to raise funds at **lower cost of capital without undergoing through rigorous procedures**.

QUESTION 63

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Banking, NPA**

With reference to different Committees in India, consider the following details:

Sl. No.	Committee	Objective	Organization under which it was formed
1	R.N. Malhotra Committee	Comprehensive reforms of Insurance sector in India	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
2	L.C. Gupta Committee	Preparing a roadmap for the introduction of derivatives trading in India	Securities and Exchange Board of India
3	Urjit R. Patel Committee	Preparing a roadmap for reforming bank lending to the Housing sector	Reserve Bank of India
4	Y.H. Malegam Committee	Preparing a roadmap for reforms in Microfinance sector in India	Reserve Bank of India

In which of the above rows are all the details correctly matched?

(a) 2 only	(b) 2 and 3
(c) 1, 3 and 4	(d) 2 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Row 1 is incorrect: In 1993, the **Government of India** (and not IRDAI) set up a committee under R. N. Malhotra to propose recommendations for reforms in the insurance sector.

Row 2 is correct: SEBI appointed L. C. Gupta Committee in 1996 to draft the policy framework for introducing financial derivatives in the Indian capital markets.

Row 3 is incorrect: The Urjit R. Patel Committee was constituted to **overhaul and strengthen India's monetary policy framework**, not for reforming bank lending to the Housing Sector.

Row 4 is correct: The RBI constituted a Sub-Committee in 2010 under Y.H. Malegam to study the issues and concerns in the microfinance sector.

QUESTION 64

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Money, Banking, Finance, Insurance** | Topic: **Banking, NPA**

Consider the following statements about the Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) in India:

1. NBFCs cannot accept demand deposits.
2. All the NBFCs operating in India have to be registered with the RBI.
3. NBFCs form part of the payment and settlement system and can issue cheque drawn on itself.
4. Deposit insurance facility of Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation (DICGC) is not available to the depositors of deposit taking NBFCs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 4	(b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 4 only	(d) 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: NBFCs **cannot accept demand deposits**.

Statement 2 is incorrect: All NBFCs do not have to be registered with the RBI. Certain categories regulated by other regulators (SEBI, IRDA) are **exempted** from registration with the Reserve Bank.

Statement 3 is incorrect: NBFCs **do not form part of the payment and settlement system** and **cannot issue cheques** drawn on itself.

Statement 4 is correct: Deposit insurance facility of DICGC is **not available** to depositors of deposit taking NBFCs.

QUESTION 65

Subject: **Economy** | Section: **Human Resource Development** | Topic: **Poverty and Development**

Consider the following statements about Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI):

1. MPI is calculated using Alkire-Foster methodology.
2. MPI calculated by NITI Aayog has a total of twelve indicators.
3. Maternal Health and Bank Account are common indicators in the MPI of NITI Aayog and MPI of United Nations Development Programme (UNDP).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only	(b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 only	(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: The global MPI's methodology is based on the **Alkire and Foster (AF) method**.

Statement 2 is correct: NITI Aayog's National MPI covers **12 indicators** while global MPI covers 10 indicators.

Statement 3 is incorrect: **Maternal Health** and **Bank Account** are the two **additional indicators** included in National MPI. They are **not included in global MPI**.

QUESTION 66

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Biotechnology & Life Sciences** | Topic: **Biology and Biotechnology**

Which of the following statements with regard to genetic medicine is/are correct?

1. Genetic medicines correct/compensate for the faulty genes responsible for disease.
2. Engineered viruses and lipid nanoparticles are used as carriers of the genetic medicine.
3. Genetic medicines alter the entire DNA sequence.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Genetic medicine/gene therapy can correct, replace, inactivate, or compensate for faulty genes responsible for disease.

Statement 2 is correct: Engineered viruses and **lipid nanoparticles** can be used as carriers/vectors to deliver genetic material into cells.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Genetic medicines **do not alter the entire DNA sequence**. They usually target a specific gene, mutation, protein pathway, or cell type.

QUESTION 67

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Emerging & Information Technologies** | Topic: **Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI**

Which of the following statements with regard to Large Language Models (LLMs) used in machine learning is/are correct?

1. LLMs assign probabilities to the next possible words and then pick the one with the highest probability.
2. LLMs process data through mathematical optimization to minimise prediction errors.
3. LLMs produce unbiased outputs.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Generative autoregressive LLMs operate as **probabilistic text predictors**. The model calculates a probability distribution across its vocabulary for the next token.

Statement 2 is correct: During training, LLMs utilize **mathematical optimization algorithms** (such as Gradient Descent) to iteratively adjust internal weights and minimize prediction errors.

Statement 3 is incorrect: LLMs are trained on vast, human-generated internet datasets. They inherently **absorb and replicate historical, systemic, and cultural biases**. Achieving completely unbiased output remains an unresolved challenge.

QUESTION 68

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

Which of the following statements with regard to stealth technology is/are correct?

1. Stealth objects have a very small radar cross-section and are coated with Radar Absorbing Material.
2. Stealth objects can be detected using specific frequencies.
3. Stealth objects are coated with metamaterials to increase the scattering of electromagnetic radiation.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Stealth design relies on minimizing an object's **Radar Cross-Section (RCS)** through geometric shaping and coating with **Radar-Absorbing Materials (RAM)**.

Statement 2 is correct: No aircraft is invisible to all radars. Stealth platforms can be detected using specific **low-frequency bands like Very High Frequency (VHF)**.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Next-generation stealth research uses metamaterials to **absorb or bend** electromagnetic waves around an object (cloaking). Coatings are **never designed to increase scattering**, as that would make the aircraft easier to detect.

QUESTION 69

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

Which of the following statements with regard to Black Boxes used in modern aircrafts is/are correct?

1. They carry a beacon emitting red light pulses to facilitate underwater detection.
2. They record both the cockpit voice and flight data.
3. Their memory units are made using either stainless steel or titanium.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Black boxes carry an **Underwater Locator Beacon**, but it does not emit red light pulses. It emits an **acoustic/ultrasonic signal (pinger)** at around 37.5 kHz.

Statement 2 is correct: Modern aircraft black boxes include two recorders: the **Cockpit Voice Recorder (CVR)** and the **Flight Data Recorder (FDR)**.

Statement 3 is correct: The Crash-Survivable Memory Unit is protected inside a strong casing made of **stainless steel or titanium**.

QUESTION 70

Subject: **Environment** | Section: **Climate Change** | Topic: **Tackling Climate Change**

Which of the following statements with regard to Green Hydrogen is/are correct?

1. It is decarbonized hydrogen obtained from natural gas reforming combined with carbon capture and storage (CCS).
2. It is produced using electrolysis of water with electricity generated by renewable energy.
3. National Green Hydrogen Mission of India aims for abatement of nearly 50 MMT of annual greenhouse gas emissions by 2030.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Hydrogen obtained from natural gas reforming with CCS is called **blue hydrogen**, not green hydrogen.

Statement 2 is correct: **Green hydrogen** is produced by **electrolysis of water** using electricity from renewable sources such as solar, wind or hydropower.

Statement 3 is correct: India's National Green Hydrogen Mission aims to create at least 5 MMT per annum green hydrogen production capacity by 2030 and expects abatement of **nearly 50 MMT** of annual greenhouse gas emissions.

QUESTION 71

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Space**

Consider the following statements with regard to involvement of private entities in India's space programme:

1. The Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe) is an autonomous agency formed to facilitate participation of private entities.
2. Agnikul Cosmos launched the world's first flight using 3D-printed rocket engine.
3. Skyroot Aerospace has developed liquid fuel for GSLV.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: IN-SPACe is a single-window, independent, nodal agency that functions as an **autonomous agency** in the Department of Space (DOS).

Statement 2 is correct: On May 30, 2024, Agnikul Cosmos launched the **Agnibaan SORTeD**, which is regarded as the **world's first rocket with a single piece 3D printed engine**.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Skyroot Aerospace develops its own dedicated fleet of commercial launch vehicles called the **Vikram series**. They have **not developed liquid fuel for the GSLV**, which is designed, owned, and operated exclusively by ISRO.

QUESTION 72

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

Which of the following statements with regard to drone swarms is/are correct?

1. They use Terahertz band of frequency to communicate with the command centre.
2. Individual drones in the swarm can communicate with other drones in the swarm.
3. GPS Spoofing is a commonly used technique to counter drone swarm attack.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Drone swarms typically communicate using standard radio frequency bands like C-band, X-band, Ku-band, or UHF/VHF/ISM bands. The **Terahertz band is not the standard frequency** used for drone swarm communication due to severe atmospheric absorption.

Statement 2 is correct: A defining feature of drone swarms is **inter-drone communication**. Individual drones exchange data to coordinate movement, avoid collisions, and perform collective operations.

Statement 3 is correct: **GPS spoofing** is a commonly used counter-drone technique in which false GPS signals are transmitted to mislead drones about their actual position.

QUESTION 73

Subject: Science & Technology | Section: Biotechnology & Life Sciences | Topic: Biology and Biotechnology

Which of the following statements with regard to GenomeIndia Project is/are correct?

1. It is a part of the Human Genome Project.
2. The project is funded by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Government of India.
3. Its primary aim is to build a catalogue of genetic diversity of the Indian population.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The GenomeIndia Project (GIP) was inspired by the Human Genome Project, but it is an **entirely separate and independent Indian national initiative**.

Statement 2 is correct: GenomeIndia is funded by the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, Ministry of Science and Technology, Government of India.

Statement 3 is correct: The primary objective is to build a comprehensive **catalogue of genetic variations** that reflect the unique diversity of the Indian population.

QUESTION 74

Subject: Science & Technology | Section: Emerging & Information Technologies | Topic: Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI

Which of the following statements with regard to the National Quantum Mission (NQM) is/are correct?

1. It aims at developing intermediate-scale quantum computers with 50 – 1000 physical qubits.

2. Its implementation includes setting up of four Thematic Hubs (T-Hubs) in academic and national R&D institutes across India.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2	(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: The Mission objectives include developing intermediate-scale quantum computers with **50-1000 physical qubits** in 8 years in various platforms like superconducting and photonic technology.

Statement 2 is correct: The implementation framework includes the establishment of **four Thematic Hubs (T-Hubs)** focusing on: Quantum Computing, Quantum Communication, Quantum Sensing & Metrology, and Quantum Materials & Devices.

QUESTION 75

Subject: **Geography** | Section: **Physical Geography - Oceanography** | Topic: **Marine Resources, Maritime Zones, UNCLOS, ISA, etc.**

Which of the following statements with regard to India's Deep Ocean Mission is/are correct?

1. It was launched by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Government of India.
2. Matsya-6000 has been designed to carry 3 people for deep sea exploration.
3. Samudrayaan is a project under this mission.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: India's Deep Ocean Mission was launched by the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**, not the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

Statement 2 is correct: **MATSYA 6000** is a self-propelled manned submersible capable of transporting **three individuals** to depths of up to 6,000 meters.

Statement 3 is correct: **Samudrayaan** is a project under the Deep Ocean Mission, focused on deep-sea exploration through a manned submersible.

QUESTION 76

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Institutions & Governance** | Topic: **Governance and Policies**

Mr. X, a senior officer, was overseeing a critical vaccination programme during a pandemic. He found that a private service provider responsible for vaccine distribution was compromising on quality to make profits. Despite immense pressure to manage the issue due to vested interests, he raised his voice based on the principles of public administration which he learnt during various training programmes attended across his career. He reported the issue to the appropriate vigilance authority and halted the contract to ensure citizen welfare.

Which one among the following principles of public administration was most strongly demonstrated by Mr. X's actions?

(a) Esprit de corps	(b) Equity
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(c) Accountability

(d) Delegation

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option c is the correct answer.**

Option c is correct: Accountability in public administration means that public officials are answerable for their actions and must ensure that public resources and public welfare are protected. It includes reporting wrongdoing, maintaining transparency, and taking responsibility in the public interest.

In the given case:

- X discovered that the private service provider was compromising vaccine quality for profit.
- Despite pressure from vested interests, he reported the issue to the vigilance authority.
- He halted the contract to protect citizens during a pandemic.

These actions clearly reflect **accountability**.

Option a is incorrect: Esprit de corps refers to the spirit of unity and team harmony – not relevant here.

Option b is incorrect: Equity means fairness and impartial treatment – the central issue here is responsibility in exposing misconduct.

Option d is incorrect: Delegation refers to transferring authority to subordinates – not relevant here.

QUESTION 77

Subject: Polity | Section: Institutions & Governance | Topic: Governance and Policies

In a multi-ethnic district where both economic competition and historical grievances frequently led to community tensions, a flashpoint has arisen with a Government decision to allocate land for a waste management facility near a tribal hamlet, sparking protests by the tribal community, which claimed that the land was sacred and critical to their cultural identity. At the same time, urban residents and local industries supported the project, citing severe solid waste challenges and health concerns due to lack of a proper disposal site. The conflict has escalated with road blockades, social media campaigns, and allegations of police excesses.

As a responsible Government official, you are tasked with resolving the situation through mediation, ensuring a sustainable outcome that balances environmental needs, tribal rights, and urban public health.

Consider the following statements with reference to the above:

1. A successful conflict resolution process must begin with acknowledging the cultural concerns of the protesting tribal community before discussing technical alternatives.
2. The Government should move ahead with the project without delay to address urban health concerns, which outweigh the sentiments of a small group.
3. Creating a multi-stakeholder dialogue platform — including tribal leaders, environmental experts, and municipal representatives — to build mutual understanding and help de-escalate tensions.
4. Conducting an independent Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) and sharing findings transparently with both sides to facilitate evidence-based decision-making.

Which of the statements given above would contribute to the resolution process?

(a) 1, 3 and 4 only

(b) 2, 3 and 4 only

(c) 1 and 2 only

(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Correct Answer: Option (A)**Detailed Explanation:****Exp) Option a is the correct answer.**

Statement 1 is correct: A sustainable conflict resolution process must begin with **acknowledging the cultural and emotional concerns** of the tribal community. Respect for indigenous identity helps build trust and reduces hostility.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Government cannot justify overriding the rights and sentiments of a vulnerable tribal community merely because urban interests are larger in number. Democratic governance requires **balancing development with social justice** and constitutional protections for tribal communities.

Statement 3 is correct: A **multi-stakeholder dialogue platform** promotes participatory governance, encourages communication, reduces mistrust, and creates scope for consensus-based solutions.

Statement 4 is correct: An independent **Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA)** provides objective evidence and supports informed, evidence-based decision-making.

QUESTION 78

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Institutions & Governance** | Topic: **Governance and Policies**

Ms. X is a mid-level civil service official working in the urban development department of a major city. Recently, she was involved in approving a contract for a public infrastructure project — a new community park. During the approval process, she received a piece of confidential information indicating that one of the shortlisted contractors had a history of poor workmanship and allegations of corruption in other cities, though nothing had been legally proven. The Head of the Department, Mr. Y, advised her not to disclose this information to the project committee or the public because it could delay the project and damage the city's reputation. However, Ms. X believed that withholding such information compromised transparency and public trust.

What amongst the following should Ms. X do now?

1. Immediately disclose the information to the project committee and the public
2. Recommend removing the contractor from the shortlist to protect the project's integrity
3. Propose a 'limited disclosure' to an oversight committee, while keeping the information confidential from the public for the time being

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only	(b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Ms. X should not immediately disclose the information to the public because the allegations have **not been legally proven**. Public disclosure without verification may violate principles of confidentiality, fairness, and natural justice.

Statement 2 is incorrect: Recommending the removal of the contractor solely on the basis of confidential allegations would be inappropriate because **no wrongdoing has been officially established**. Public procurement decisions must be based on verified evidence and due process.

Statement 3 is correct: Proposing a **limited disclosure to an oversight or vigilance committee** is the most balanced and ethical approach. It ensures that the information is examined by competent authorities while maintaining confidentiality until properly verified.

QUESTION 79

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Part III, IV & IVA: Rights and Duties** | Topic: **Fundamental Rights**

'X' was addressing a seminar on the meaning of the term 'law' as provided under Article 13, Part III of the Constitution of India. 'X' explained that the meaning of the term 'law' in the Constitution of India was very comprehensive. It included ordinances, orders and even rules and regulations. 'Y' pointed out that the term 'law' in Article 13 also included custom or usage having in the territory of India the force of law, to which 'X' was not convinced.

Based on the above, select the correct conclusion from the options given below:

(a) 'X' is correct in the interpretation of law, including the view on non-inclusion of custom.	(b) The view of 'Y' that 'law' included custom is not correct.
(c) The views of both 'X' and 'Y' are correct.	(d) The view of only 'Y' is correct.

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Article 13(3)(a) of the Constitution defines the term "law" in a very broad manner. It includes **ordinances, orders, bye-laws, rules, regulations, notifications, customs, and usages** having the force of law within the territory of India.

X stated that the term "law" includes ordinances, orders, rules, and regulations – this part is correct. However, when Y pointed out that the term also includes "custom or usage having the force of law," X was not convinced. This makes **X's interpretation legally incorrect and incomplete**.

Y's statement is fully correct because it accurately reflects the wording and intent of Article 13. Hence, the correct conclusion is that **only Y's view is correct**.

QUESTION 80

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Foundations & Framework** | Topic: **Salient Features of the Indian Constitution & Comparison with Other Countries**

Consider the following statements with reference to the Constitution of India:

1. There is no Article in the Constitution of India that specifies that the Constitution of India will be officially called the 'Constitution of India'.
2. There is no Article in the Constitution of India that specifies that the Indian Independence Act, 1947 and the Government of India Act, 1935 stand repealed.
3. There is no Article in the Constitution of India that mentions 26th January, 1950 as the date of the commencement of the Constitution of India.

Which one of the following conclusions based on the above statements is correct?

(a) All three statements are correct.	(b) There is no correct statement.
(c) There are two correct statements that include statement 3.	(d) There is only one correct statement.

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: **Article 393** explicitly provides: "This Constitution may be called the Constitution of India."

Statement 2 is incorrect: **Article 395** states that the Indian Independence Act, 1947 and the Government of India Act, 1935 are repealed.

Statement 3 is incorrect: **Article 394** explicitly states: "...the remaining provisions of this Constitution shall come into force on the twenty-sixth day of January, 1950."

Therefore, **all three statements are incorrect**, and the answer is **(b) There is no correct statement**.

QUESTION 81

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Institutions & Governance** | Topic: **Governance and Policies**

Which of the following statements with regard to the persons with disabilities in India is/are correct?

1. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, an Act passed by the Parliament of India in 2018, mandates reservation in education and employment, places a legal duty on Governments to ensure accessibility and non-discrimination.

2. The Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan focuses on achieving universal accessibility for Persons with Disabilities across three key domains – built infrastructure, transport systems and information and communication technology.

3. The National Divyangjan Finance and Development Corporation (NDFDC) is a public sector organization set up by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs as a not-for-profit company to promote entrepreneurship among Persons with Disabilities (PwDs).

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3	(d) 1 only

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act was passed in **2016, not 2018**. It came into force on 19 April 2017.

Statement 2 is correct: The **Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan** (Accessible India Campaign), launched on 3 December 2015, focuses on achieving universal accessibility across three key domains — **built infrastructure, transport systems and information and communication technology (ICT)**.

Statement 3 is incorrect: NDFDC functions under the **Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (Divyangjan), Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment**, not under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs.

QUESTION 82

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Part VIII & X: Union Territories and Scheduled Areas** | Topic: **Scheduled and Tribal Areas**

Consider the following statements about the provisions pertaining to the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes in India:

- Provisions regarding the administration of the Tribal Areas in the States of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram are given in the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution of India.
- Some tribes of India are entitled to exemption from paying Income Tax on certain incomes.
- The Constitution of India provides for reservation of seats in Panchayats for women belonging to the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes.

Which one of the following conclusions based on the above statements is correct?

(a) There are two correct statements, that include statement 2.	(b) There are two correct statements, that are statements 1 and 3.
(c) There is only one correct statement.	(d) All three statements are correct.

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The provisions regarding Tribal Areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram are in the **Sixth Schedule**, not the Fifth Schedule.

Statement 2 is correct: Under **Section 10(26) of the Income Tax Act, 1961**, members of Scheduled Tribes residing in specified tribal areas are entitled to exemption from income tax on certain incomes.

Statement 3 is correct: **Article 243D** provides for reservation of seats for SCs/STs in Panchayats, and not less than one-third of the seats reserved for SCs/STs must be reserved for **women** belonging to SCs/STs.

QUESTION 83

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Part V & VI: The Union and The States** | Topic: **Parliament Procedures, Proceedings, Officers, Bills, Committees, Houses, etc.**

Consider the following statements in respect of questions asked by the Members in the Parliament of India:

1. Unstarred questions are those to which a Member desires an oral answer in the House.
2. Starred questions are those to which a Member desires a written answer.
3. No supplementary question can be asked on an unstarred question.

Which one of the following conclusions based on the above statements is correct?

(a) All the three statements are correct.	(b) There are two correct statements, that include statement 2.
(c) There is only one correct statement.	(d) There is no correct statement.

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: An **Unstarred Question** is one to which a **written answer** is desired and is deemed to be laid on the Table of the House. It is NOT called for oral answer.

Statement 2 is incorrect: A **Starred Question** is one to which a member desires an **oral answer** from the Minister in the House, distinguished by an asterisk.

Statement 3 is correct: **No supplementary question can be asked on an unstarred question** because the answer is given only in written form and no oral discussion follows.

QUESTION 84

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Part V & VI: The Union and The States** | Topic: **Parliament Procedures, Proceedings, Officers, Bills, Committees, Houses, etc.**

Consider the following statements about the Committee on the Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes of the Parliament of India:

1. Although members of this Committee are elected from both Houses of Parliament, the Chairperson of this Committee is appointed by the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.
2. Twenty members are elected by the Rajya Sabha and ten members by the Lok Sabha.
3. No minister, except for the Union Minister of Social Justice and Empowerment, is eligible to be a member of this Committee.
4. Members are elected for a fixed term of two years from the date they enter their office.

Which one of the following conclusions based on the above statements is correct?

(a) There are four correct statements.	(b) There is only one correct statement, that is statement 2.
(c) There are two correct statements, that include statement 1.	(d) There is no correct statement.

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Chairperson is appointed by the **Speaker of the Lok Sabha**, not by the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The composition is: **20 members elected by the Lok Sabha** and **10 members elected by the Rajya Sabha** (reversed in the statement).

Statement 3 is incorrect: **No Minister is eligible** to be a member of the Committee. There is no exception for any Minister.

Statement 4 is incorrect: The term of the Committee is **one year**, not two years.

Hence, **all four statements are incorrect.**

QUESTION 85

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

Consider the following statements about Mission Sudarshan Chakra of India:

1. It aims to enhance India's air defence and aerial offensive capabilities.
2. This Mission is being designed to enhance rapid, precise, and powerful defence responses, reinforcing India's strategic autonomy.
3. One of the aims of this Mission is to cover all public places of India by an expanded nationwide shield by 2035.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is correct: Announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on August 15, 2025, **Mission Sudarshan Chakra** is designed as a comprehensive, multi-layered air and missile defence initiative serving a dual "shield and sword" role.

Statement 2 is correct: The mission focuses on creating **rapid, precise, and powerful defence responses** through an integrated, AI-enabled, multi-layered system, emphasizing indigenous development (Atmanirbhar Bharat) to reinforce India's **strategic autonomy**.

Statement 3 is correct: All public places will be covered by the expanded nationwide security shield **by 2035**.

QUESTION 86

Subject: **International Relations** | Section: **India's Foreign Policy & Bilateral Relations** | Topic: **India and Neighbourhood (Pakistan, China, Nepal, Sri Lanka, etc.)**

Consider the following statements about river bridges connecting India with neighbouring countries:

1. 'Maitri Setu', built over Feni river, connects Ramgarh in India with Sabroom in Bangladesh.
2. Jhulaghat Suspension Bridge connects India with Myanmar.
3. Mechi bridge and its approaches connect Panitanki Bypass in India with Kakarvitta in Nepal.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 only	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: Maitri Setu is built over the Feni River. The bridge connects **Sabroom in Tripura (India) with Ramgarh in Bangladesh**, and not Ramgarh in India with Sabroom in Bangladesh.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Jhulaghat suspension bridge connects **India (Pithoragarh district, Uttarakhand) with Nepal** over the Kali River (Mahakali River), not with Myanmar.

Statement 3 is correct: The Mechi Bridge connects **Panitanki Bypass in India (Darjeeling District, West Bengal) with Kakarvitta in Nepal** over the Mechi River.

QUESTION 87

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Institutions & Governance** | Topic: **Governance and Policies**

Which of the following statements about a Zero First Information Report (Zero FIR) Under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 is/are correct?

1. A Zero FIR can be lodged at a police station, even though the place of commission of a cognizable/non-cognizable offence is outside the territorial jurisdiction of that police station.
2. The Officer-in-charge of the police station where a Zero FIR has been lodged may, with the permission of the competent authority, initiate a preliminary enquiry.
3. Under Zero FIR, it is obligatory for the informant to furnish information electronically.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only	(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: A Zero FIR can be registered at any police station irrespective of territorial jurisdiction, but **only in cases of cognizable offences**. Non-cognizable offences are not covered.

Statement 2 is correct: Section 173(3) of the BNSS introduces a framework for "Preliminary Enquiry." For offences punishable with imprisonment between 3 and 7 years, the Officer-in-Charge may conduct a preliminary enquiry "**with the prior permission of an officer not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police.**"

Statement 3 is incorrect: Any person can report a cognizable offence **either orally or in writing or by electronic communication**. Electronic communication is one option, **not an obligation**.

QUESTION 88

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Institutions & Governance** | Topic: **Extra-Constitutional Bodies**

With reference to the organizations under the Government of India, consider the following details:

Sl. No.	Organisation	Function	Controlling Union Ministry
1.	Central Economic Intelligence Bureau (CEIB)	To coordinate between various law enforcement agencies	Ministry of Home Affairs
2.	Serious Fraud Investigation Office (SFIO)	To investigate complex corporate frauds	Ministry of Finance
3.	Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)	To preserve values in public life and ensure the health of the national economy	Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pension

In how many of the above rows are the given details correctly matched?

(a) 1	(b) 2
(c) 3	(d) None

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Row 1 is incorrectly matched: CEIB works under the **Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance**, not under the Ministry of Home Affairs. (Function is correct, ministry is wrong.)

Row 2 is incorrectly matched: SFIO operates under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs**, not the Ministry of Finance.

Row 3 is correctly matched: The CBI functions under the **Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) of the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**. Both function and ministry are correct.

Thus, **only one row is correctly matched**.

QUESTION 89

Subject: **International Relations** | Section: **Global Institutions & Agreements** | Topic: **Global Groupings and Agreements (FTA, Paris Agreement, NPT, QUAD, etc.)**

Which of the following international conventions have not been ratified by India?

1. Employment Policy Convention
2. Abolition of Forced Labour Convention
3. International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Their Families
4. Geneva Convention Relative to the Protection of Civilian Persons in Time of War
5. Convention on Reduction of Statelessness

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 2 and 4	(b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 and 4 only	(d) 3, 4 and 5

Correct Answer: Option (D)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Option 1 is incorrect (ratified): India ratified the Employment Policy Convention (ILO Convention No. 122) in **1998**.

Option 2 is incorrect (ratified): India ratified the Abolition of Forced Labour Convention (ILO Convention No. 105) in **2000**.

Option 3 is correct (NOT ratified): India has **not ratified** the International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Their Families.

Option 4 is incorrect (ratified): India is a party to **all four Geneva Conventions of 1949**.

Option 5 is correct (NOT ratified): India has **not ratified** the Convention on Reduction of Statelessness (1961).

The correct answer should ideally be 3 and 5 only. However, since this combination is not given, the most appropriate answer is **(d) 3, 4 and 5**.

QUESTION 90

Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Emerging & Information Technologies** | Topic: **Information and Communication Technology, Robotics, AI**

Consider the following statements with respect to the AI Impact Summit, 2026 held in New Delhi:

1. The Summit's Intellectual framework was based on three foundational Sutras: People, Planning, and Progress.
2. The Preamble of the Summit Stresses Democratising AI Resources, which acknowledges the charter for Democratic Diffusion locally relevant innovation and strengthen resilient AI ecosystem while respecting national laws.
3. The New Delhi Declaration On AI Impact was structured around seven Chakras (Pillars), Which included Access for Social Empowerment, AI for Science, and Secure and Trusted AI.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3	(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 3 only

Correct Answer: Option (D)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The three foundational Sutras were: **People, Planet, and Progress** — not "People, Planning, and Progress."

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Declaration explicitly states the Charter for the Democratic Diffusion of AI is a "**voluntary and non-binding framework**", not binding.

Statement 3 is correct: The New Delhi Declaration on AI Impact was structured around **seven Chakras (Pillars)** of cooperation, including Access for Social Empowerment, AI for Science, and Secure and Trusted AI.

QUESTION 91

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *India's Foreign Policy & Bilateral Relations* | Topic: *India and Neighbourhood (Pakistan, China, Nepal, Sri Lanka, etc.)*

Which of the following connectivity projects is/are a part of cooperation between India and the ASEAN member countries?

1. Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project
2. IMT Trilateral Highway
3. Agartala-Akhaura Rail Line

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3	(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Option 1 is correct: Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project is between India and **Myanmar** (an ASEAN country).

Option 2 is correct: IMT Trilateral Highway is between India, **Myanmar** and **Thailand** (both ASEAN countries).

Option 3 is incorrect: Agartala-Akhaura Rail Line is between India and **Bangladesh**. Bangladesh is **not an ASEAN country**.

QUESTION 92

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *India's Foreign Policy & Bilateral Relations* | Topic: *India and Neighbourhood (Pakistan, China, Nepal, Sri Lanka, etc.)*

Match List I with List II and select the answer using the code given below the Lists:

List I (Project Supported by India)	List II (Country)
A. Mangdechhu Hydroelectric Project	1. Maldives
B. Restoration of Stor Palace	2. Afghanistan
C. District Hospital at Dickoya	3. Bhutan
D. Institute of Security and Law Enforcement Studies	4. Sri Lanka

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a) 1 4 2 3	(b) 3 2 4 1			

(c) 3 | 4 | 2 | 1

(d) 1 | 2 | 4 | 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

A → 3: Mangdechhu hydroelectric project – **Bhutan**B → 2: Restoration of Stor Palace – **Afghanistan** (2016)C → 4: District Hospital at Dickoya – **Sri Lanka** (2017)D → 1: Institute of Security and Law Enforcement Studies – **Maldives****QUESTION 93**Subject: **Science & Technology** | Section: **Space & Defence Technology** | Topic: **Defence**

Which of the following items of defence hardware is/are manufactured in India?

1. Su-30 MKI Fighter Jets
2. T-90 MKI-III Tanks
3. Akula Class Submarine

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2

(b) 1 and 3

(c) 1 only

(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (A)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Option 1 is correct: Su-30 MKI is manufactured at Aircraft Division Nasik of **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)**.**Option 2 is correct:** T-90 MK-III Tanks are manufactured in India by the **Heavy Vehicles Factory at Avadi, Chennai**. Known as Bhisma Tanks.**Option 3 is incorrect:** Akula Class Submarine is manufactured in **Russia** and leased/imported by India.**QUESTION 94**Subject: **International Relations** | Section: **Global Institutions & Agreements** | Topic: **Global Groupings and Agreements (FTA, Paris Agreement, NPT, QUAD, etc.)**

Consider the following statements about platforms of multilateral co-operation:

1. The 'Colombo Process' is a regional consultative process in which member states take binding decisions by consensus.
2. The 'Abu Dhabi Dialogue' is a voluntary non-binding consultative process among Asian Countries of labour origin and destination to facilitate regional cooperation on contractual labour mobility.
3. The 'Global Forum for Migration and Development', created upon the proposal of a former UN Secretary General, is a voluntary forum whose decisions are non-binding in nature.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3

(b) 1 and 3 only

(c) 2 and 3 only

(d) 2 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Option 1 is incorrect: The Colombo Process is **non-binding** and decision-making is by consensus.

Option 2 is correct: Abu Dhabi Dialogue (ADD) is a regional, **voluntary and non-binding** consultative Process established in 2008.

Option 3 is correct: Global Forum for Migration and Development (GFMD) was created upon the proposal of UN Secretary General **Kofi Annan** in 2006. It is **voluntary, informal and non-binding**.

QUESTION 95

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *Global Institutions & Agreements* | Topic: *International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)*

Consider the following UN organization/agencies:

1. World Food Programme
2. United Nations Children's Fund
3. United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
4. International Labour Organisation

How many of the above has/have been awarded the Nobel Prize twice?

(a) 1	(b) 2
(c) 3	(d) 4

Correct Answer: Option (A)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

WFP: Nobel Peace Prize **once** (2020)

UNICEF: Nobel Prize **once** (1965)

UNHCR: Nobel Prize **twice** (1954 and 1981) ✓

ILO: Nobel Peace Prize **once** (1969)

Only **one** agency (UNHCR) has been awarded the Nobel Prize twice.

QUESTION 96

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *Global Institutions & Agreements* | Topic: *International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)*

Match List 1 with List 2 and select the answer using the code given below the Lists:

List 1 (UN Peacekeeping Operation)	List 2 (Period of Operation)
1. UNMIL	1. 2007 – 2010
2. MINURCAT	2. 2002 – 2005
3. MINUSTAH	3. 2003 – 2018
4. UNMISSET	4. 2004 – 2017

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a) 3 4 1 2		(b) 3 1 4 2		
(c) 2 1 4 3		(d) 2 4 1 3		

Correct Answer: Option (B)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

A (UNMIL) → **3**: September 2003 – March 2018

B (MINURCAT) → **1**: September 2007 – December 2010

C (MINUSTAH) → **4**: June 2004 – October 2017

D (UNMISSET) → **2**: May 2002 – May 2005

QUESTION 97

Subject: *International Relations* | Section: *Global Institutions & Agreements* | Topic: *International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)*

Match List 1 with List 2 and select the answer using the code given below the List:

List 1 (BIMSTEC Centre/Establishment)	List 2 (Location)
A. BIMSTEC Cultural Industries Observatory	1. NOIDA
B. BIMSTEC Energy Centre	2. Bengaluru
C. BIMSTEC Centre for Weather and Climate	3. Colombo
D. BIMSTEC Technology Transfer Facility	4. Thimphu

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a) 3 2 1 4				
(b) 3 1 2 4				
(c) 4 2 1 3				
(d) 4 1 2 3				

Correct Answer: Option (C)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

A → **4**: BIMSTEC Cultural Industries Observatory – **Thimphu, Bhutan**

B → **2**: BIMSTEC Energy Centre – **Bengaluru, India**

C → **1**: BIMSTEC Centre for Weather and Climate – **Noida, India** (at NCMRWF)

D → **3**: BIMSTEC Technology Transfer Facility – **Colombo, Sri Lanka**

QUESTION 98

Subject: *Science & Technology* | Section: *Space & Defence Technology* | Topic: *Defence*

Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

(Indian Army Corps)	(Headquarters)
(a) 3 Corps Dimapur	(b) 4 Corps Tezpur
(c) 14 Corps Leh	(d) 33 Corps Srinagar

Correct Answer: Option (D)**Detailed Explanation:**

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

3 Corps: Dimapur ✓

4 Corps: Tezpur ✓

14 Corps: Leh ✓

33 Corps: Sukna, Darjeeling (West Bengal) – NOT Srinagar ✗

QUESTION 99

Subject: **Polity** | Section: **Part IX, IXA, IXB: Local Governments** | Topic: **Local Government Panchayats, Municipalities, Cooperative Societies**

Which of the following statements with respect to the Revamped Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan (RGSA) is/are correct?

1. The period of its implementation is 1st April, 2021 to 31st March, 2026.
2. The key objective of the Revamped RGSA is to develop the governance capabilities of the Panchayati Raj Institutions to deliver on the Sustainable Development Goals.
3. The share of the Central funding for the Revamped RGSA is 100% for all states and Union Territories.

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2	(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3	(d) 2 and 3

Correct Answer: Option (B)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Revamped RGSA is implemented during the period **FY 2022-23 (1st April 2022) to 2025-26 (31st March 2026)**, not from 1st April 2021.

Statement 2 is correct: The key objective is to develop the **governance capabilities of the Panchayati Raj Institutions** to deliver on the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** adopting 9 thematic approaches through participatory local planning.

Statement 3 is incorrect: Revamped RGSA is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme** (not a Centre Sector Scheme). Hence the share of Central funding is **not 100%** for all States and Union Territories.

QUESTION 100

Subject: **International Relations** | Section: **Global Institutions & Agreements** | Topic: **International Organizations (UN, IMF, World Bank, ASEAN, BRICS, etc.)**

Which of the following countries are members of the European Union?

1. Belarus
2. Poland
3. Germany
4. Switzerland

Select the answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 4	(b) 1 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 3	(d) 2 and 4 only

Correct Answer: Option (C)

Detailed Explanation:

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The EU has **27 Member States** including:

Poland ✓

Germany ✓

Belarus and **Switzerland** are **NOT** members of the European Union.
